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Piedmont Post

A Community Newspaper Serving the Citizens of Piedmont

Candidates' Q & A – City Council Week 4

By Jake Lannon

Each election cycle, the *Piedmont Post* provides extensive coverage of each candidate to help residents make informed voting decisions.

For this year's race, the *Post* will send one question every week to the candidates running for City Council in the November 3 election. The five City Council candidates vying for three open seats received the question on Wednesday, September 16, and were asked to reply with a 200-word response.

Week 4 question:

What, in your view, are the city's top 3 infrastructure needs? If elected to the council, which of these needs would you prioritize addressing? And why?

Adam Hundt
(AdamHundt.com)

The top 3 infrastructure needs for Piedmont are: first, mitigating risk from hazards that could affect residents' housing; second, the renovation and modernization of city buildings (including Police and Fire departments) and the improvement of sewer and storm drain infrastructure; third, the upkeep of roads and enhancements to crosswalks and bike pathways to ensure resident safety and mobility.

First, I support the Fire Department's outreach work with residents to address hazards by switching from gas to home electrification and managing vegetation on one's property to reduce wildfire risk. Piedmont's 2025 Local Hazard Mitigation Plan (LHMP) noted the near 100% likelihood of catastrophic wildfires occurring in the next year or every year.

Second, aging infrastructure is not up to code and challenges city departments' ability to provide resident services. Piedmont Police and Fire departments need modern facilities that adequately accommodate personnel and equipment. The Recreation Department, which provides programming for children, needs repair.

Piedmont must improve its city sewers to meet obligations from a Consent Decree Order. The Regional Water Quality Control Board has stormwater management requirements.

Third, Piedmont must continuously maintain its roads; enhance crosswalk, sidewalk, and path safety and accessibility for pedestrians and bicyclists; and reduce speeding.

Tom Ramsey
Incumbent
(vote4tomramsey.com)

We live in a beautiful, historic town, but our infrastructure requires aggressive stewardship to keep Piedmont functioning at a high level. Three critical needs stand at the top:

Sewers and Storm Drains: We lead neighboring cities in complying with federal sanitary sewer mandates, but 30% of the project remains. We must stay on track using State Revolving Fund low-interest loans, while preparing storm systems for El Niño.

Pavement Management: Staff excels at securing state and county revenues, but rising construction costs outpace funding, causing our Pavement Condition Index (PCI) score to slip. We must inject more capital here; every dollar spent on maintenance saves up to ten dollars in future reconstruction.

Aging Civic Buildings: Modernizing facilities far exceeds current revenue. I echo the Budget Advisory Committee's guidance: ongoing planning, quantification, and strict prioritization are vital given long lead times.

If elected, I will prioritize Pavement Management. While sewer compliance is mandated and facility upgrades require long-term planning, road maintenance offers the most immediate fiscal leverage. Letting streets deteriorate creates a compounding liability. Prioritizing preservation now protects tax dollars from being wasted on catastrophic road failures, keeping Piedmont safe and fiscally sound.

Bill Reichle
(ReichleforPiedmont.com)

Given the age of our infrastructure, Piedmont has more maintenance and capital needs than available dollars. As a result, identifying, prioritizing, sequencing, and funding infrastructure projects is a continuous discussion between the city administrator, city council, and residents.

See Candidates Q&A on page 28



Ms. Brenneman's class performs the Maypole Dance. *Photos by Anne Smith and Jay Russell*

7th Graders host annual Medieval Faire

By Milana Miller

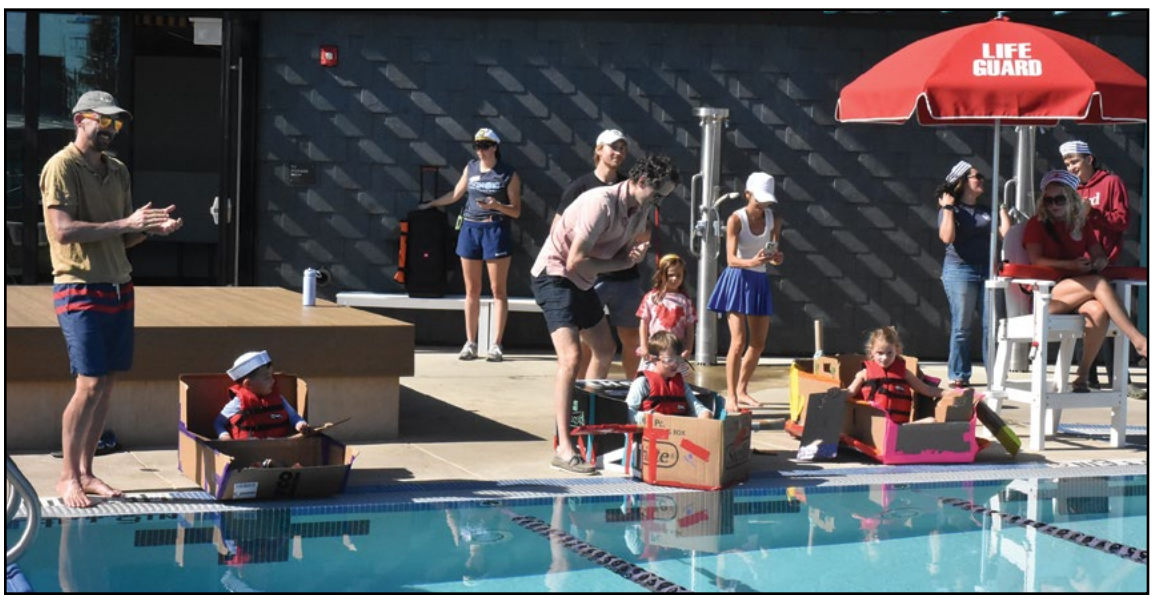
On Friday, September 18, the annual Medieval Faire was held at Piedmont Middle School. The Medieval Faire is an event for 7th graders as a way to experience what life was like during Medieval times. The school tradition dates back over 30 years. The students elected a king, queen, and nobility, and everyone dressed in period costumes. The monarchy and nobility made speeches welcoming everyone, and different classes performed during the "banquet" of cookies and juice. Lastly, everyone went to the pickleball courts where Medieval games were set up.

One of the classes spent their social studies periods making games for the faire: Fortune Telling, Ring Around the Rosie, Donut on a String, Soak-a-Serf, Cornhole, and Hoop Rolling, taking place on the pickleball courts. Some of the most popular games were Soak-a-Serf, where someone stood in a pillory while others pelted them with sponges, and Donut on a String, a competition for the first to finish a donut suspended in the air by a string without their hands.

Overall, most people thought that the fair was a fun way to see how it was in Medieval times, reinforcing the things they learned in social studies.

(See additional articles and photos on pages 8 and 9)

Piedmont's Cardboard Boat Race brings families together



Racers prepare to enter the water with the help of parents.

By Jake Lannon

On Saturday, September 19, Piedmont hosted the Cardboard Boat Race at the Community Pool. Over 20 families came to the pool to build boats from scratch and race against other kids in their age group. The event took over the Activity Pool from 2 p.m. to 6 p.m. Kids ages five through 12 designed and built a boat using cardboard, then launched it into the pool to see if it could make it across the water.

Saturday's event had three age brackets. Families had an hour and a half to build a cardboard

See Boat Race on page 32



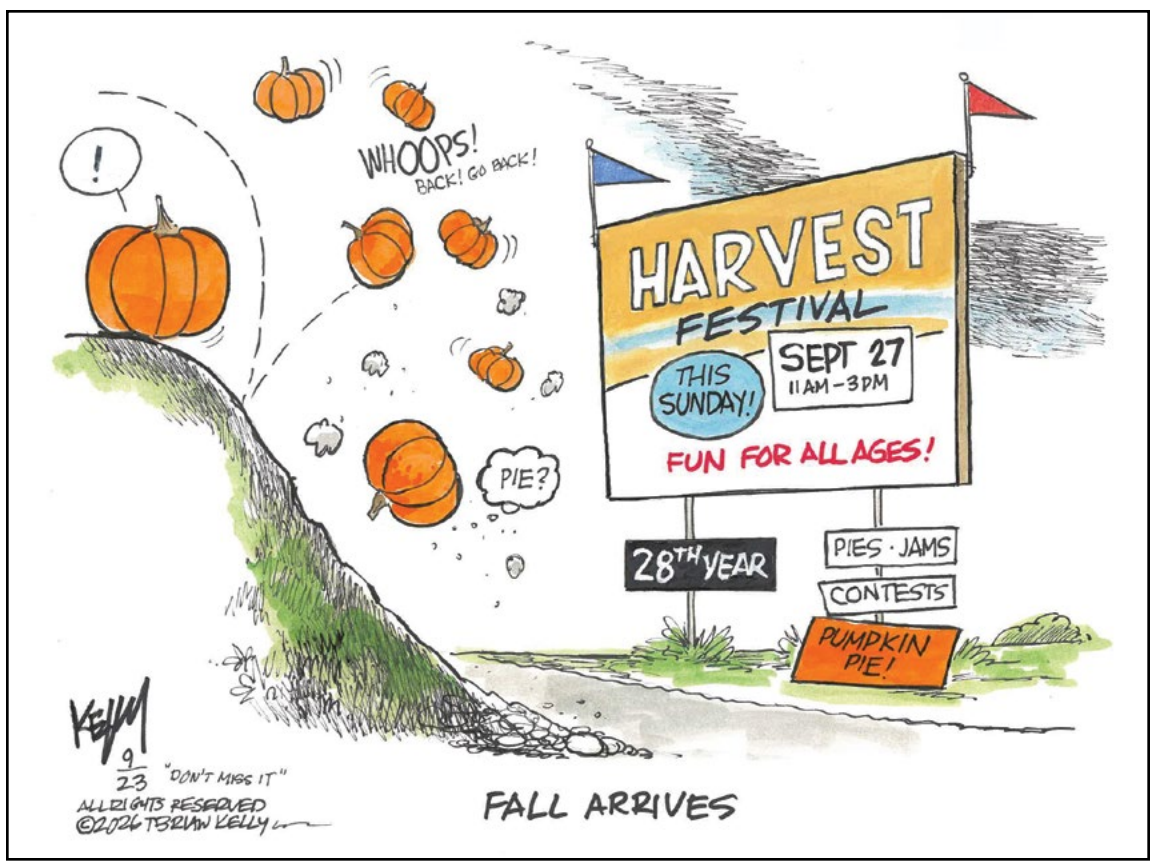
The Heywood family won the age 7 & under competition with their boat and well-designed paddle.

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OUR PAPER • OUR *POST*

Opinion



Letters to the Editor

In support of Beninati for City Council

Editor,

I am writing to express my support for Nancy Beninati for Piedmont City Council. Nancy has the experience, integrity, leadership skills, and commitment to public service needed for the role.

I worked for many years with Nancy at the California Department of Justice. Nancy dedicated over 25 years of her career to working at the DOJ and I saw firsthand how well she balanced multiple interests and priorities, while keeping her focus on improving the lives of California people. She led multiple sensitive, complex matters where sound judgment was critical. On a personal level, Nancy served as a supervisor and mentor to me and many other attorneys, and challenged us to grow while always making us feel supported. I am confident that Nancy will draw from the skills and leadership qualities I observed and be an exceptional City Council member.

Nancy's unwavering commitment to public service extends to our community. She has served as President of the League of Women Voters of Piedmont, on the Civil Service Commission, and on the Recreation Commission, and she has volunteered in our schools and youth programs. It is precisely this demonstrated, longstanding commitment to Piedmont that I look for in a City

See Letters on page 28

Piedmont Post

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Collecting photos for Where in the World

For 28 years, Piedmont residents have made sure their travels are well documented, with photos of family members reading the *Piedmont Post* in far-off places throughout the world, and some nearby.

The *Post* invites families to send photos with the *Post* from near and far for publication in *Where in the World Are We* on the back page of the paper. With people able to travel once again, there is no better time to have your photo in the *Post.*

Send photos as .jpg files to: news@piedmont-post.com, and be sure to include a brief description of the location where the photo was taken.

READ IT IN THE *POST*

Quote of the Week

"Honesty is the first chapter in the book of wisdom."

– Thomas Jefferson
1743-1826
Third President of the United States

Viewpoint

Former mayor says YES to Measure GG

I strongly recommend Piedmont voters support Measure GG on this November ballot. Measure GG is a "transfer tax," a one-time assessment collected when property is sold or ownership is transferred. The current Piedmont transfer tax was set in 1993. It has not been updated in 33 years.

The transfer tax is a one-time tax levied on a property at the time of sale and is often split between the buyer and the seller. Piedmont does not have sales tax or any significant commercial tax revenue, so the transfer tax is a critical source of income and represents 10% of the annual operating budget of the City.

Proceeds from Measure GG will stay in Piedmont and support our core City services through the City's General Fund. The City uses those revenues to partially pay for repair of aging City buildings, streets and sidewalks, parks, public safety and recreation.

Our neighboring communities of Oakland, Berkeley, Emeryville, and Richmond have all increased their transfer taxes far higher than Measure GG. While Piedmont home prices have risen in the last few years, maintenance expenses and construction costs for roads, sidewalks and storm drains have risen even faster.

As a former Councilmember and Mayor, and now Chair of the Budget Advisory and Financial Planning Committee, I have had a front row seat to City revenues and expenditures for the past 14 years. I can attest that the City Council has taken, and continues to take, a conservative approach to budgeting and expenditures. A long-overdue increase in the transfer tax would provide the City with revenue to continue to provide essential services and maintain the basic City infrastructure upon which we all rely. Please join me in voting YES on Measure GG.

– Bob McBain,
Former Mayor
Chair of the Budget Advisory and Financial Planning Committee

A stronger Piedmont starts with protecting what makes our community special

I am writing in support of Measure GG, which will appear on the November 3 ballot.

Piedmont is a remarkable community because of the things we have built and maintained together—excellent public safety, responsive police and fire services, beautiful parks, well-maintained streets and sidewalks, and the many community services that contribute to the quality of life we value so highly.

Measure GG provides an important source of funding to help preserve those services for the future. The measure would increase Piedmont's one-time real property transfer tax from 1.3% to 1.75% and is expected to generate approximately $1.5 million annually in additional general tax revenue.

What I particularly appreciate about this approach is that it is a one-time tax paid when a property changes hands, rather than an annual tax on every Piedmont homeowner. The cost of the transfer tax can also be negotiated as part of a real estate transaction.

For those of us who live in Piedmont, the value of our community is not simply the homes we own. It is the security of knowing that our police and firefighters are there when we need them. It is the quality of our parks, roads, sidewalks and public spaces. It is the investment we make in maintaining the infrastructure and services that make Piedmont such a special place to live.

The City has identified significant ongoing needs, including aging buildings, infrastructure, parks, stormwater systems, roads and sidewalks, in addition to essential public safety and emergency services.

I believe maintaining these services is an investment in the community we all care about. Measure GG provides an opportunity to help ensure that Piedmont continues to be the safe, beautiful and exceptionally well-served community we know and love.

I encourage my fellow Piedmonters to vote YES on Measure GG this November.

Sincerely,
–Teresa Baum, Realtor

How to get news in the *Post*

The *Piedmont Post* welcomes its readers to express their opinions on any topic. Columns in the *Piedmont Post* are exclusive and may not be reprinted without permission.

The *Post* reserves the right to edit any pieces or letters submitted. Opinion pieces should be limited to 400 words, letters to the editor to 200 words.

Photo submissions: Please submit photos at 6 inches in width and at a resolution of 200 dpi in jpeg format.

Do you have some news? Send your photos or stories to 1139 Oakland Avenue, Piedmont, CA 94611, or email them to news@piedmont-post.com. It's that easy. (Send us an attachment or cut and paste your text into the body of the email.)

The deadline for submitting news, photos and opinion items is Friday.

League of Women Voters of Piedmont to host forum for City Council candidates next week, Sept. 29

Join the League of Women Voters of Piedmont (LWVP) on Tuesday, September 29, for a candidate forum. It will feature candidates on the Piedmont City Council ballot in the November 3, 2026, General Election. The forum will be held at 7:00 p.m. in the City Council chambers and in overflow space as needed. It will include the following five candidates running for three positions: Nancy Beninati, Nancy Bostrom, Adam Hundt, Tom Ramsey, and Bill Reichle.

Piedmont voters can learn more about the City Council forum at lwvpiedmont.org. Registration is required to attend the live forum, as space is limited. The forum will also be broadcast and recorded on KCOM. After the forum, the recording will be available on LWVP's website, on LWVP's YouTube channel, and through the websites of KCOM and the City.

A LWVP representative will moderate the forum. It will include questions from the public. Questions will be reviewed to ensure a range of topics and issues.

Visit the Election Resources page (https://bit.ly/4ymy5xS) to learn about WHAT's on your ballot and HOW, WHEN, and WHERE to vote. A ballot will be mailed to every registered voter starting October 5. Ballot drop-off locations will open October 6. If you have moved or changed your party or your name, you can update your registration online. The last day to register to vote is October 19.

There are three ways to vote in Alameda County: 1) mail your ballot, 2) drop off your ballot at a secure ballot drop-box in the county, or 3) vote in person or drop off your ballot at any vote center in the county. The list of vote centers will be updated as the Registrar of Voters confirms the sites. There will likely be a ballot drop-box in central Piedmont next to the mailbox near the Piedmont Community Church. There will likely be a vote center in Piedmont at the Veterans Memorial Building at 401 Highland Avenue.

A limited number of additional early 10-day in-person Alameda County vote centers will also be open starting October 24. A limited number of additional early 4-day in-person Alameda County vote centers will also be open starting October 31. Vote-by-mail ballots must be postmarked on or before Election Day.

The League of Women Voters is a non-partisan political organization. It does not support or oppose any political party or candidate.

Democracy is not a spectator sport!

The League of Women Voters is a non-partisan political organization that encourages informed and active participation of citizens in government.

The League
- provides voter services and registration
- educates kids about the election process
- influences public policy through education and advocacy

JOIN THE LEAGUE OF WOMEN VOTERS OF PIEDMONT

90 years ago it was just for women. Today it's for everyone.

For information, call Linda McClain at 653-4255
or go to www.lwvpiedmont.org

KNOW THE ISSUES. BE PART OF THE CONVERSATION.

PERSPECTIVE

Measure GG: Transfer Tax FAQ

By Conna McCarthy, Vice Mayor

What is the Real Estate Transfer Tax?

The transfer tax is a one-time assessment collected when property is sold or ownership is transferred.

Transfer tax revenue in Piedmont funds day-to-day costs for police, fire, emergency response, public works, recreation, and other services, as well as the maintenance and replacement of aging infrastructure and facilities.

Who pays the Transfer Tax?

Piedmont's transfer taxes are typically split equally between buyer and seller when a home is sold, although the parties may negotiate a different arrangement.

ABOUT MEASURE GG

What would Measure GG do?

Measure GG would increase Piedmont's Real Estate Transfer Tax rate from 1.3% to 1.75% of the sale price of real property – from $13 to $17.50 per $1,000.

If approved by a majority of voters, the new rate would take effect July 1, 2027.

Measure GG is estimated to generate $1.5 million in additional revenue annually. Actual revenue will vary based on the number of sales and sales price.

How would Piedmont's rate compare with neighboring cities?

Measure GG would bring Piedmont's rate more in line with neighboring cities.

In Oakland, the rate is 1.75% for sales between $2 million and $5 million and 2.5% for sales above $5 million. In Berkeley, the rate is 2.5% for sales of $1.6 million or more.

What prompted the City to update the transfer tax?

Piedmont has had a local transfer tax since 1968. As other neighboring cities have modified theirs, Piedmont's transfer tax has not changed since 1993, which was 33 years ago.

The City is facing a long-term gap between the cost of maintaining existing city services, facilities, and infrastructure and the revenues available to support them. Piedmont has no significant revenue from retail, and the cost of rehabilitating City buildings, parks, streets, sidewalks, stormwater drains and other infrastructure are rising.

The increase was recommended by the Budget Advisory and Financial Planning Committee, after the City Council asked that they explore options for addressing Piedmont's long-term needs.



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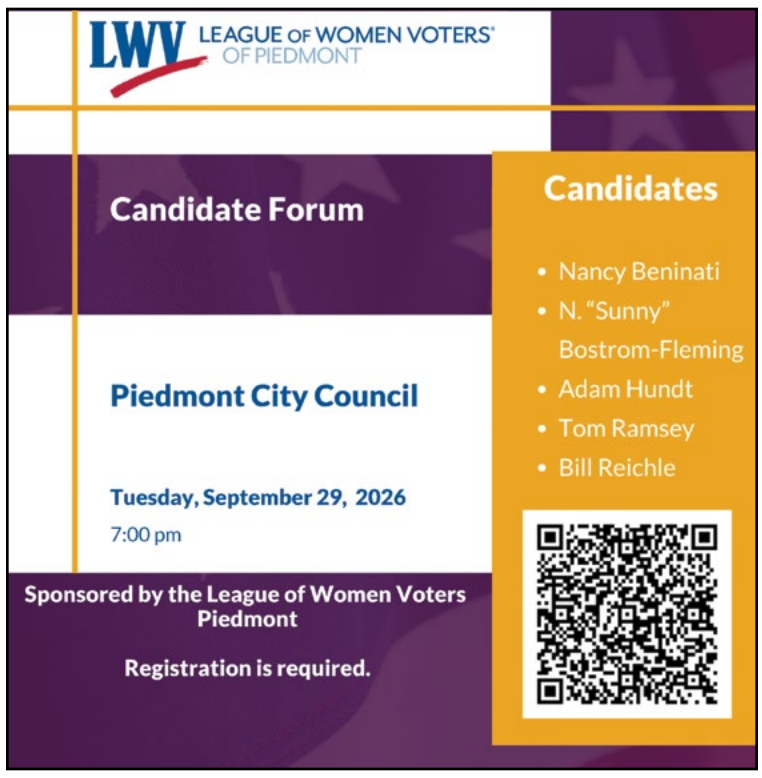
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Thank you for supporting your Piedmont Post.

Local Items

Annual Harvest Festival returns for the 28th year on Sunday

By Jake Lannon

Piedmont's Harvest Festival returns for its 28th year this Sunday, September 27. Attendees will enjoy a day of food, music, art, and community traditions throughout Piedmont Park from 11 a.m. to 3 p.m. The festival kicks off the fall season for Piedmont families.

The Edibles Contest has been part of the Harvest Festival since the beginning and remains its centerpiece. Each year, Piedmont's community creativity and talent shine as tables fill with homemade breads, pies, cookies, jams, and homegrown produce. To enter, residents can download the entry form at piedmont.ca.gov/EdiblesContest and drop their entry off with a label at Piedmont Community Hall from 7:30 to 10 a.m. on the morning of the festival.

This year's Harvest Festival will feature an expanded Farmers' Market, including local honey, flowers, vegetable starts, skincare products, and more. The Watermelon Eating Contest will return this year after last year's success. Competitors will line up and eat a watermelon as fast as they can; the first one done wins. Sign-up is on-site, and the competition starts at 1 p.m.

Scarecrow Alley will be crowded with student scarecrows to be auctioned. All auction proceeds benefit Beach, Havens, and Wildwood. For more information, contact the Piedmont Education Foundation: info@piedmontedfoundation.org. The Harvest Festival will host an Art Show at the Tea House, featuring work from Piedmont artists. Those interested in becoming an exhibitor may contact Jane Reed at (510) 654-2670.



Two local kids trying their best at the PEF Carnival



Judges at last year's Edibles Contest survey the food and make their decisions.

The Kids' Carnival features fun games like ring toss, alien invasion, Krazy Kan, and more. The carnival benefits Piedmont elementary schools. Families can buy their kids a wristband in advance at PiedmontStore.org. A wristband gets you unlimited carnival games, one walk-through at the Cake Hop, and one snow cone.

Seven food trucks plus Oakland's Line 51 Brewing will be available for attendees to enjoy. Piedmont's community groups will host tables to showcase their organization with a "harvest" theme.

The Harvest Festival is searching for volunteers. Shifts are available from 8:30 to 11:30 a.m. for set-up and 3 to 5 p.m. for event breakdown. Contact Recreation Supervisor Eva Phalen at ephalen@piedmont.ca.gov to sign up. For more information, including vendor lists, schedules, edibles contest entry forms, and volunteer opportunities, visit piedmont.ca.gov/HarvestFestival.

25th Annual Jazz Festival this Sunday at the Harvest Festival

By Jake Lannon

The Annual Piedmont Jazz Festival celebrates its 25th year this Sunday, September 27. The festival will take place on an open stage in front of the Piedmont Community Hall starting at 11 a.m. This free city-sponsored event will be held in conjunction with the Harvest Festival and the School Carnival.

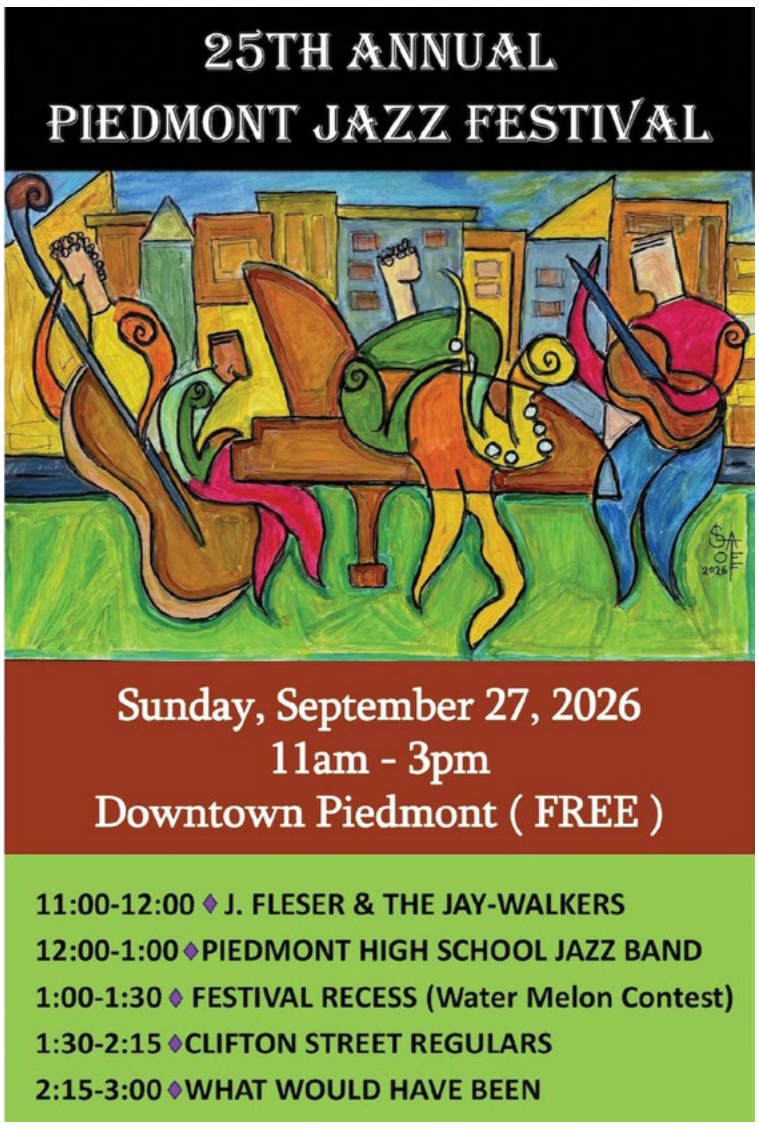
For 25 years, the festival has celebrated Piedmont's rich musical talent. This year's performers will include the Piedmont High School Jazz Band, the Clifton Street Regulars, J Fleser and the Jaywalkers, and What Might Have Been. Each performance will last close to an hour.

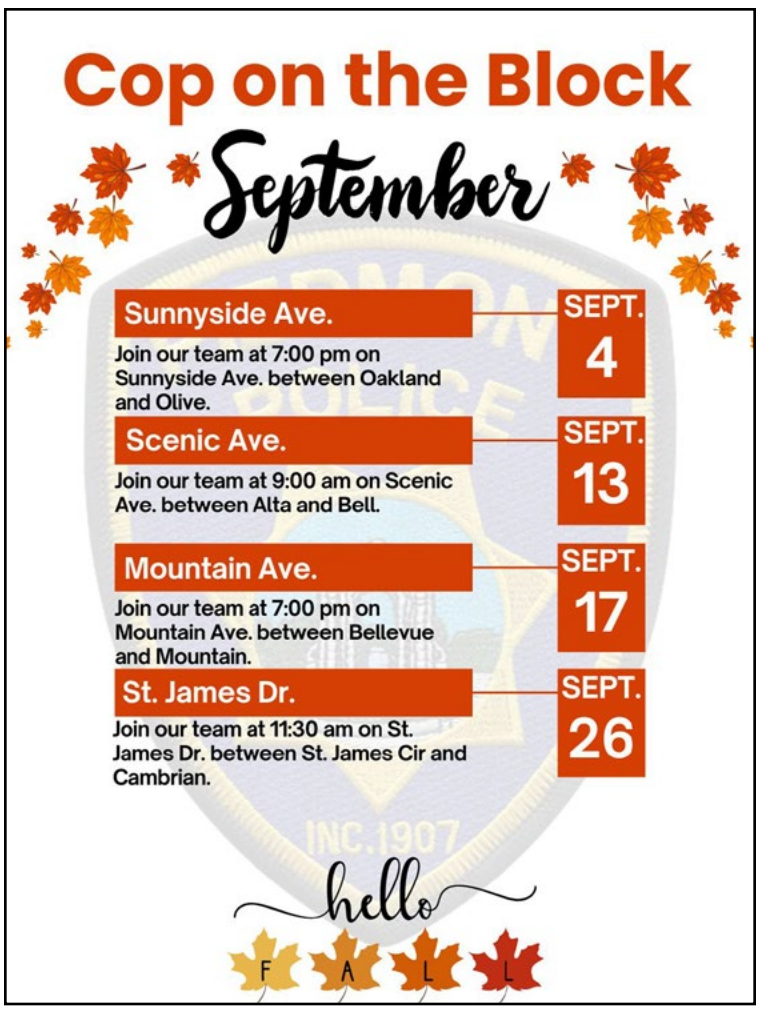
The festival will run alongside the Harvest Festival, providing Piedmont Park with music while people play games, visit community tables, and participate in competitions. The Jazz Festival will take a 30-minute recess at 1:00 p.m. for the Watermelon Eating Contest.

To learn more about the Jazz Festival and the Harvest Festival, visit the city's website: https://piedmont.ca.gov/news/events/harvest_festival.



The Clifton Street Regulars are one of the performers for this Sunday's Jazz Festival.







Children's Fairyland to host Drawn Together event

An Adults-Only (21+) Evening of Live Art for Bay Area Artists



A local artist is live painting a piece for a guest at Drawn Together.

Children's Fairyland announces the return of its "artsiest party of the year." Drawn Together will take place on Friday, September 25, from 6:00 p.m. to 10:00 p.m. For this special evening, Fairyland opens exclusively to adults ages 21 and over, offering a rare opportunity for grown-ups to explore the magical world of Fairyland, a place typically reserved for children and their families. Tickets are now on sale.

An intimate evening of live art, cocktails, and creative connection. The 21-and-over event invites art lovers to watch more than 50 local artists and industry professionals create original, Fairyland-inspired artwork live throughout the park. As the night winds down, the energy shifts into a wildly spirited art sale, where guests can take home a piece created that very evening for just $50.

"It's an open-air art gallery meets a bar meets a theme park meets a party meets an art sale," said Fairyland's Artistic Director Shannon Taylor of the one-of-a-kind event, which blends the whimsy of Fairyland's storybook setting with a full slate of adult entertainment.

Drawn Together is an adults-only playground, featuring cocktails, food trucks, live art being made in real time by local visual artists, puppet shows, live music, tarot card readings, artists' meet-and-greets, an infamously spirited art sale, and an evening showing of Fairyland's current puppet production, The Three Little Pigs in the 1920s. Guests can explore Fairyland's iconic storybook sets, from Willie the Whale to the Alice in Wonderland card maze. Tot-sized rides and animal areas will be closed for the evening.

Guests who would prefer a guaranteed place are welcome to purchase a Patron Ticket. Patron Ticket holders will receive a numbered, limited-edition Children's Fairyland print created exclusively for Drawn Together 2026, along with early entry to the event. It gives guests a chance to avoid the lines, speak with artists before the crowds arrive, and secure a piece of art early, all while donating to Children's Fairyland.

Proceeds from Drawn Together will support the people, programs, and spaces that make Children's Fairyland magic possible year-round — from free field trips for under-resourced communities to hands-on workshops that bring creativity to life for young visitors. Tickets are $35 for general admission, $30 for members, and $100 for Patron. Tickets and event information can be found on Fairyland's website: https://secure.fairyland.org/4337/4338.



Girl Scout Troop hosts garage sale fundraiser

By Audrey Levin and Mina Herrgott

Girl Scout Troop #33521, made up of 15 high school juniors, will host a garage sale on Sunday, September 27, selling interesting used items from their homes to promote sustainability while fundraising for their activities. The garage sale will take place at 39 Craig Avenue, just a few blocks away from the park, from 12 p.m. to 4 p.m.

The garage sale will coincide with the Harvest Festival, the yearly gathering of music and food in Piedmont Park. This gives people enjoying the Harvest Festival an opportunity to explore vintage clothes, children's toys, sports gear, and handmade objects, from jewelry to ceramics.

Girl Scout Troop #33521 was started in 2017 and has grown from a few students at Wildwood to almost 20 members from Piedmont and Oakland. They have done a variety of activities and gone on many adventures, ranging from camping to learning from Piedmont's firefighters. Their earlier years were characterized by badge earning – first aid, babysitting, woodworking, eating healthy, and more.

Many of the members completed a Silver Award in middle school. Girls spent more than 50 hours addressing a community issue. Two girls advocated to reduce food insecurity, another pair built a website about animal care, and one pair created a brochure to support new immigrants in the East Bay.

Now students at Piedmont High School, Head Royce, and College Preparatory, they're focused on volunteering and earning their Gold Awards, the most prestigious award in Girl Scouts and the next step after their Silver Award. Girl Scouts pursuing a Gold Award need to have at least 80 hours of work with prominent experts to create a profound, lasting impact on their community in an area of their choice. Some examples of Gold Award projects include supporting girls in a male-dominated sport, increasing excitement about math for kids, and educating people to empower introverts.

Girl Scout Troop #33521 invites you to their Garage Sale Fundraiser. Please stop by to give these amazing items a new home and, in doing so, support these young entrepreneurs.



Girl Scout Troop #33521 on its annual camping trip. They are at Tomales Bay, waiting to see bioluminescence in the water

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Schools

School Board Meeting tonight

By Jay Russell

Piedmont's Board of Education will convene for a regularly scheduled meeting tonight, September 23 at 7:00 p.m. in City Hall at 120 Vista Avenue. The meeting will be highlighted by a state of the school presentation from Havens Elementary Principal Susanne Reed.

The Havens report will provide valuable information for Havens parents. Reed will outline instructional technology policies of the city's oldest elementary school such as "No computer use in TK or K." She will also provide information on the new ELA & Math STAR testing which will be computer-based three times per year for grades 2-5.

The school board will also explain during the meeting why they are foregoing a formal election for the two open school board seats. Board President Ruchi Medhekar and board member Lindsay Thomasson were the only two candidates in the election.

"WHEREAS, it would be an unnecessary expenditure of City and District resources to hold an election for two seats on the Board of Education with only two candidates on the ballot," states the district's resolution.

This will be the second meeting under the direction of Interim Superintendent Donald Evans and also the second for the fall student board members, junior Diego Branneria of Piedmont High and junior Corrine Minor of Millennium High School.

The meeting will also be streamed live on KCOM-TV, channel 27 and on Zoom at Zoom.us/j/86989977122?pwd=16QZ-RI7pGPQJFuIrT8ErH91scga3l4.1

California's COMPASS research resources to be eliminated

Librarians provide warning about upcoming state cuts

By Jay Russell

Piedmont librarians published a *Letter to the Editor* in the September 2 *Piedmont Post* describing the imminent lose of the COMPASS program at the end of this school year. Educators and librarians are currently calling on state legislators to restore funding for the California Online Media Program for Access and Student Success (COMPASS), a statewide program that provides K-12 students and teachers with free access to high-quality, vetted online research resources.

The 2026-27 state budget eliminates COMPASS funding after July 1, 2027, ending the state's $5.5 million annual investment in the program.

COMPASS databases include Encyclopedia Britannica, PBS videos, PebbleGo, Gale, National Geographic for Kids, ProQuest, and TeachingBooks. Media resources slated to be lost include encyclopedias, research databases, and scientific journals.

"We cannot imagine doing our work of teaching media literacy and research skills without this program," Piedmont librarians stated.

Since 2018, COMPASS has provided free access to research and curriculum resources to California's public schools. The program's resources are verified by teachers and credentialed school librarians. Since its launch, the program has received over 700 million searches.

California ranks 49th nationwide in school librarian staffing, with nearly 10,000 students for each librarian, according to research by the Institute of Museum and Library Services. Without librarians or research tools, K-12 students will have to fend for themselves.

According to a CalMatters article the state allotted funds for COMPASS in earlier budget versions but is directing the funding elsewhere. Instead, $5 million of the funding is going toward the state's new dyslexia screener. Read more at Calmatters.org/education/k-12-education/2026/06/school-libraries-california/

The cost of replacing COMPASS will be dramatically higher if schools and districts are required to purchase the resources independently. According to the California State Library, individual schools subscribing to comparable COMPASS materials would spend more than $216 million annually.

To send Governor Newsom an email urging him to restore this resource visit: Saveschoollibrarians.org/compass2026.

Thinking Outside the Classroom

Putting the PSAT into Perspective

By Emily Thompson and Ariel Rodriguez

Many high schools throughout the country will be hosting the PSAT in October, but what is the PSAT?

PSAT stands for Preliminary Scholastic Aptitude Test, essentially the precursor to the SAT. Like the SAT, the PSAT is a digital, adaptive test that includes a Reading & Writing section and a Math section. Both the SAT and PSAT are 2 hours and 14 minutes long. There are also some major differences between the PSAT and the SAT. The PSAT is only offered once per year, in October, and is typically hosted by your high school. The SAT, on the other hand, is offered eight times per year at test centers throughout the country. The maximum scaled score on each section of the PSAT is 760; the maximum scaled score on each section of the SAT is 800.

If you are a junior taking the PSAT, your scores could qualify you for National Merit Commendation or National Merit Semifinalist. Many schools will also allow sophomores to take the PSAT, but only scores from junior year can qualify for national merit recognition. Exact score cutoffs are determined by state in the year following the PSAT taken. So, a junior taking the PSAT Fall 2026 will not find out if they have received national merit commendation or semifinalist status until 2027. Commended students are typically within the top 3-4% of testers; semifinalists are typically within the top 1% of testers. Historically, California has been one of the states with the highest cutoffs.

Students who are National Merit Semifinalists can apply to become National Merit Scholars. National Merit Scholar status makes you eligible for different scholarships: some from the National Merit Scholarship Corporation, some from private corporations, and others from colleges and universities themselves.

While there are some perks for students who score in the top percentiles on the PSAT, for the vast majority of students, the PSAT mainly functions as a practice test. If the PSAT is being offered at your school, go ahead and take it and put in a good faith effort, but don't put undue stress on this test. Instead, use it as an opportunity to gain more information that will empower you to understand how standardized tests may become part of the bigger picture for college admissions.

Ariel is the Co-Director of College Consulting and Emily is the Managing Director at Study Smarter. Study Smarter has been providing individualized academic tutoring, test preparation, and college counseling to Piedmont families since 1997. Ariel has worked in undergraduate admissions at both public and private universities. For more information, please visit www.studysmarter.com, email info@studysmarter.com, or call (510) 350-8444.

READ IT IN THE *POST*

PHS phone policy too spartan for some students

By Ayla Blanford

The new phone policy at Piedmont High School, which forces students to keep phones and personal internet-connected devices in backpacks for the entirety of school days, has caused unforeseen consequences as students try to adjust to a different campus environment. After six weeks of the new policy, many students are expressing frustration over the restriction of their phones.

According to the 2026-2027 student handbook, the current board of education policy limits cell phone usage during the school day to only a "dumb phone," a phone equipped only with text and call features. Students began to see the new policy's enforcement on day one of school, August 10, with cell phones being confiscated by school staff and Campus Supervisor Darnell Reed.

"The phone policy has been very effective so far," junior Cassidy Carter said. "Especially with the scaring tactic of phones being taken to the office, and the threat of having to turn your phone in every day at the beginning of the school day."

Many students are frustrated the policy was created to begin with, citing bigger issues that the school should be focusing on instead.

"I don't think it addresses an actual issue, if anything it's more work for the teachers," junior Maika Ting said. "They're the ones having to enforce it and our old policy didn't really have any issues."

With each violation of the phone policy, consequences increase. The first offense causes phones to confiscated for the day and comes with an email to parents. Further disciplinary action include revoking phone privileges for the remainder of the year, daily phone drop-offs, and assignments to progressive disciplinary. A fourth offense results in ineligibility for school activities.

"The punishments are a little too harsh. It's likely that many students will get their phones taken since we are slightly reliant on them," Carter said. "It's unfair to have to turn them in in the mornings on only the second offense."

Classes such as yearbook and journalism occasionally require cell phone use, which has caused frustration and difficulty when classes are given exceptions, according to students.

"It's necessary to have them on you at all times for pictures, interviews, or notes." Carter said. "Administrators didn't really understand that there was no need for a change."

Students also rely on their cell phones to contact family members throughout the day, and the phone policy limits their ability to do so.

"I don't think they [the administration] understand that students use their phones as a way to talk to their parents at school," sophomore Olivia Nealon said. "Many people rely on lunch to talk to their parents about after school plans."

With lunch being the only period where students can go off campus and use their phones, there has been a decrease in students spending lunch on campus, changing the campus atmosphere in an unexpected way. Students said there are possible improvements to be made to make the policy more effective and sustainable for further years.

"Having a hard reset for a number of phone offenses at different times throughout the school year would be better," Carter said. "Or some other punishment that is a little more lenient for students."

Ayla Blanford is a junior at Piedmont High School and a student intern writer with the Piedmont Post.

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Piedmont Makers launches the FIRST Tech Challenge season

On Saturday, September 12, the Piedmont Makers hosted a season kickoff and watch party for the unveiling of the 2026-27 FIRST Tech Challenge theme at the new community robotics and maker space on 10th Street in Oakland.

FIRST Tech Challenge (FTC) challenges middle and high school students to design, build and program robots to compete in a new game each year. Working with mentors, students develop engineering skills, teamwork and strategies for competition.

A local non-profit dedicated to K-12 STEAM education, the Piedmont Makers offers hands-on learning opportunities through robotics, maker programs, teacher grants and community events. The organization has expanded beyond Piedmont, with programs serving over 1,000 students from 139 schools across the Bay Area during the 2026-2027 season. Piedmont Makers' programming starts in kindergarten and continues through high school. "It's a really amazing program that impacts a lot of kids for a very long time," says Paul Morrison, the co-leader of the Piedmont Makers FIRST Tech Challenge.

The 7,000-square-foot 10th Street facility serves as a hub for the local maker and robotics community. The space provides a full-size robotics practice field and access to specialized equipment like CNC routers, and has hosted over 30 robotics teams throughout the Bay Area in the past year.

Highlander Robotics, Piedmont Makers' capstone high school team, first had the idea: a full-size, community-accessible robotics practice field. The team opened one at a temporary space in Oakland, giving Bay Area teams that used to drive to East Palo Alto for practice a home in the East Bay. When rent rose at that location, the team partnered with Piedmont Makers to find a long-term site. With grants from the PG&E Corporation Foundation, the KLA Foundation, and over one thousand volunteer hours from the team, the 10th Street facility opened in the fall of 2025.

From the beginning, the vision for the new space extended beyond just serving its own teams. "We're always thinking about how we can expand our impact," says Piedmont Makers co-president Ben Stein. "The impetus for investing in the 10th Street facility was not just to serve a single team or chapter; it was the goal of creating regional infrastructure for youth throughout the whole Bay Area. That's the real magic."



Images courtesy of FTC team #37264

Members of FTC team #37264, *CTRL-ALT-Defeat!* L-R: Jeremy Block, Kai Chiles, Tristan Lu, Parsa Tarapore, & Jack Dove



Images courtesy of FTC team #37264

Co-leaders of the Piedmont Makers FTC Laura Chu and Paul Morrison unveil the season's theme to the FTC teams.

For Kai Chiles, a middle school student and member of FTC team #37264 *CTRL-ALT-Defeat!*, the 10th Street space offers a chance to learn from older students. "The space is cool because we get to see the older teams practice and how their robots work," he said. "The reveal was exciting, and I'm very interested to see how everyone's robots are going to look this season."

His teammate Tristan Lu echoes the enthusiasm, saying, "I'm very excited for this FTC season. Right after the reveal, we started immediately building and modifying our robot for the competition."

The Piedmont Makers ecosystem is powered by a broad community of students, parents, mentors and partner teams. "The heroes of the Piedmont Makers program are really the kids and our volunteer parents," says Stein. "We have roughly 300 volunteers, along with teams from across the region contributing labor, parts, and other support. At the end of the day, it's about building a village to support the amazing work all these kids are doing."

To learn more about the Piedmont Makers or to get involved as a volunteer, visit piedmontmakers.org

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Medieval Garb

By Owen Cain

What could a 7th grader love more than getting to skip 6th period to eat wafers, play games and dress up in internet-bought cloaks, dresses and polyester trousers?

Piedmont Middle School's annual Medieval Faire, given on the 18th of September, in the first year of the reign of King Leo Sahuc and Queen Ember McCall, was full of joy and festive chaos. It was a period where you could be anyone from the Medieval Ages, from archbishops to the rats carrying the bubonic plagues.

Everyone dressed in colorful attire. Some favorites were the plague doctors, dressed in deep, black robes (sable, if you may) and those horrifying crow masks.

Another interesting garment to note was the riding cloak. It's such a beautifully cut piece of fabric, trimmed at the ankle and crowning the shoulders, pinned together with an elegant brooch. The vibrant hoods and capes added a certain swashbuckling effect to costumes.

With crow masks and cloaks discussed, I still must ask what could a medieval faire be without its fair share of fair maidens? There were several glamorous dresses, featuring deep blues and rich greens worn by our nobles and queen. These flowing dresses allowed for a very stately gait, present in all the faire's activities.

And although the faire is over, surely all medieval apparel will be remembered.



Jesters Claire Horton (left), and Kira Arulanantham



Isabelle Taylor (left), Calliope Johnson, and Jona Hansen



Photos by Anne Smith and Jay Russell

Medieval King Leo Sahuc (left), Vice Principal Adam Saville, Principal Jamie Van Kleeck, and Queen Ember McCall



Skye Vincze gets a look into the future by fortune teller Siow Fang Tan.

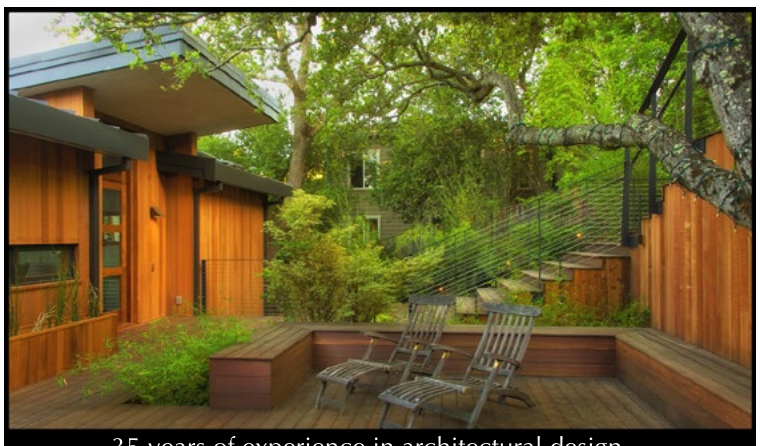


Adi Dolev (left), Raven Oliverwheeler, and Melantha Wong



Caleb Litle takes aim at a donut on a string during the carnival games.

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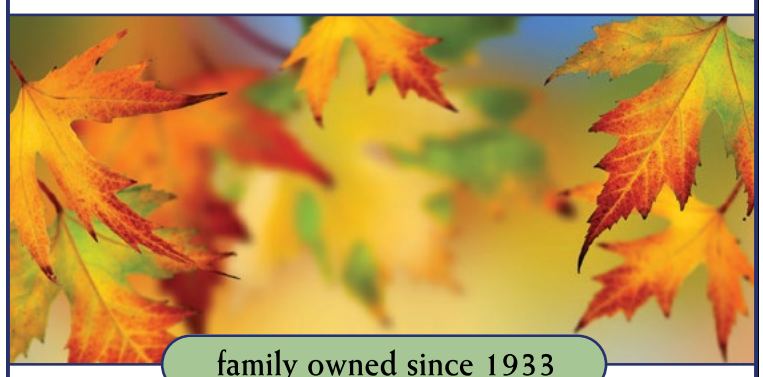
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Medieval performances

By Jonah Kerr

Trumpets blast out onto Piedmont Middle School's lower courtyard, telling (very) excited 7th graders that the first performance of the 7th grade medieval Faire is starting. It includes medieval performances by different homeroom classes.

It started with the Maypole dance done by Ms. Brenneman's homeroom. This dance consisted of people with pieces of different colored rope walking around a pole, while people threw flowers at them. People with green rope went clockwise, while people with blue rope went counter-clockwise. Every time someone passed someone else of a different color, they would alternate between going over or under the other person's rope.

Next, all the kids went down to the MPR where the rest of the performances took place. The first performance was the royalty dance, for the two 7th graders who were the king and queen. People did spins, twirls, and wide sweeping arm motions around a red carpet made from construction paper.

Next, there was a skit on medieval manners. It included cool facts, like how you were supposed to drop the bones of the meat on the floor after eating, and how you were only allowed to put three fingers into a serving pot.

It was then time for us to get our food. Parents came around, serving a king-sized bar of wafers and juice to each kid. The meal had a lot of sugar and tasted very sweet.

The circle dance came next. People danced in different size circles, starting with one person and going up to the whole homeroom. After that, we were all dismissed to the next part of the faire – the games. There is a reason the Medieval Faire is a highlight of the year for Piedmont Middle School 7th students.

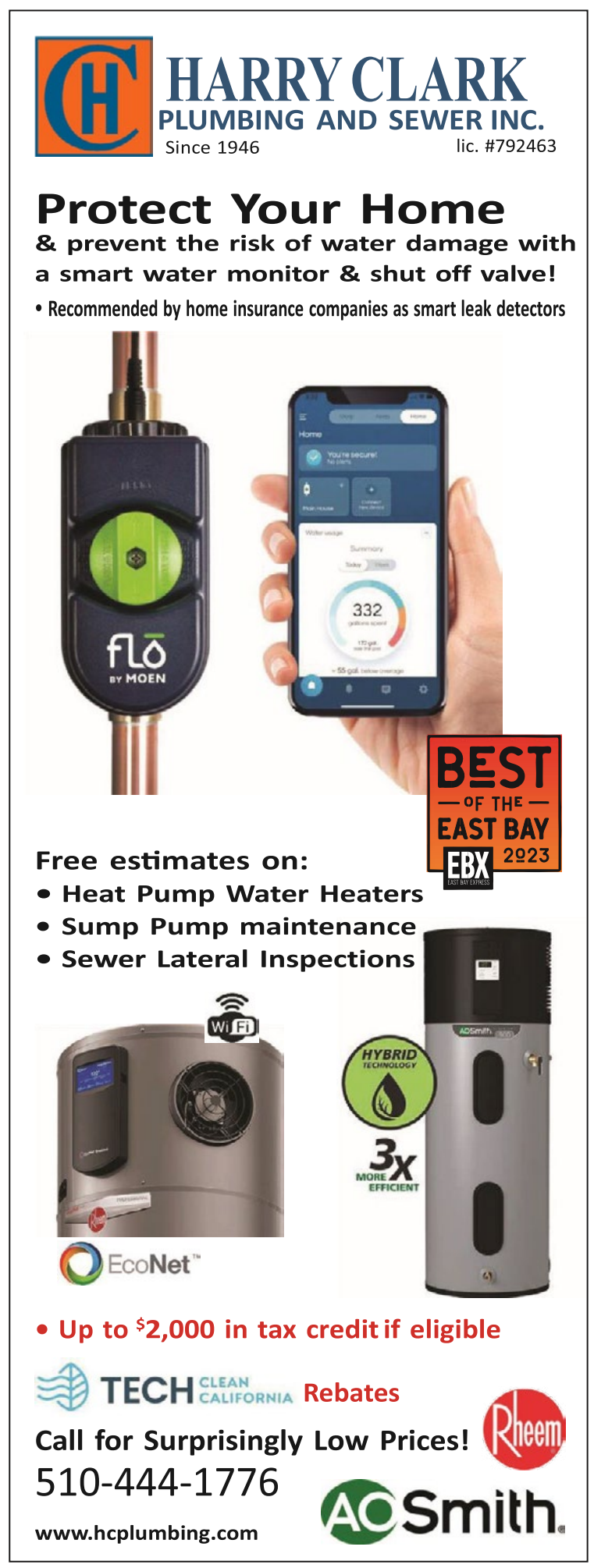


Ms. Heckey's class performs the Royalty Dance on a red carpet at the banquet.



Ms. Hare judges a round of Ring around the Rosie.







Orion Fund's 20th annual Golf Tournament an interstellar cause

By Jay Russell

The Piedmont-based non-profit Orion Fund will host its 20th annual Golf Tournament and Banquet at Chardonnay Golf Club in Napa on Saturday, October 24. Tickets are affordable and go to the best of causes, supporting college students undergoing medical emergencies in California.

The Orion Fund non-profit started at the behest of Piedmont moms two decades ago following the death of PHS graduate Orion Trott from cancer at the age of 21. They have awarded more than $850,000 to college students in times of urgent need. The Orion Fund provides grants for students amidst any health crisis including organ transplants, car crashes and cancer diagnoses. The Orion Fund primarily serves low-income students without family support, many of whom are first-generation college students and working while enrolled.

"We put a safety net under them so that they can recover and complete a hard-won education," said Orion Fund President Pam Hirtzer.

Since the Orion Fund began in 2004 it has assisted 500 college students with grants, so kids battling an injury or setback can stay enrolled in college. The Orion Fund has sent tuition to more than 65 schools in California, supporting local kids of all demographics, under any medical crisis, for any academic pursuit. Grant winners have also applied their funds to keep their health insurance or pay their rent while ill.

Twenty-seven grant recipients already selected for the next year depend upon the continued support of donors to the Orion Fund.

"It is seriously difficult to fundraise for non-profits in this day and age. We can't help everybody, and have to turn kids away that would otherwise qualify," said Hirtzer.

A tee-time in the October 24 golf tournament and a seat for the banquet dinner costs $165; this also includes cart rental and range balls. The shotgun start begins at 12:00 p.m. and at 5:00 p.m. there will be a banquet dinner, along with an auction, tournament awards and a golden raffle. This year's top prize in the raffle is a $5,000 week-long stay at a luxury resort in Cabo San Lucas donated by an Orion Fund Board member.



The Chardonnay Golf Course in Napa is the site of the 20th annual Orion Fund Golf Tournament on October 24.



The non-profit and all-volunteer Orion Fund was founded by eight Piedmont moms in 2004.

The Orion Fund Golf Tournament regularly hosts 70 golfers a year, and hopes for 100 this year on the 20th anniversary. The tournament is a scramble,and welcomes all ability levels to compete, from scratch golfers to those just looking to have fun while supporting a good cause.

Contact Pam via Pam@theorionfund.org for more information and register now at Theorionfund.org/events

STREET SWEEPING SCHEDULE – 2026-27

Street sweeping is critical for keeping storm drains clear during leaf drop season. Residents should move cars and any other obstacles blocking access to the curb off the street on street sweeping days.

September 21 - October 2

Mon.	Tues.	Wed.	Thur.	Fri.
September 21	22	23	24	25
1-Odd	**2-O**	**3-O**	**4-O**	**5-O**
September 28	29	30	October 1	2
1-Even	**2-E**	**3-E**	**4-E**	**5-E**

E = Even Street Numbers O = Odd Street Numbers

Streets, by Zones — **Indicates streets where both even and odd addresses are swept on "even" days*

ZONE 1
Ashmount Ave
Cambrian Ave
Cavanagh Ct *
Crest Rd
Crocker Ave
(South of La Salle Ave)
Croydon Circle *
Estates Dr
Florada Ave
Glen Alpine Rd
Hampton Rd
(East of Sea View Ave)
Huntleigh Rd
Indian Rd
Indian Gulch Rd
Inverleith Terr
La Salle Ave
La Salle Ct *
Lafayette Ave
Lexford Rd
Marlborough Ct *
Muir Ave
Sandringham Pl
Sandringham Rd
Sea View Ave
(Between La Salle & Crocker)
Selborne Dr
Somerset Rd
Sotelo Ave
St James Circle
St James Dr
St James Place
Trestle Glen Rd
Tyson Circle
Valant Place
Wildwood Gdns
Wistaria Way
Woodland Way
Wyngaard Ave

ZONE 2
Arroyo Ave
Bonita Ave
(North of Park Way)
Cambridge Way
(West of Grand Ave)
Estrella Ave
Grand Ave – *ODD*
(Bet Wildwood & Cambridge)
Grand Ave
(Between Cambridge & Rose including Lower Grand)
Greenbank Ave
(West of Grand Ave)
Holly Place
Howard Ave
Kingston Ave
Lake Ave
Linda Ave
Lorita Ave
Lower Grand Ave
Manor Dr
Monticello Ave
Nace Ave
Oakland Ave
(West of Grand Ave)
Olive Ave
Park Way
(Between Monticello & Bonita)
Parkside Dr *
Ramona Ave
Ronada Ave
Rose Ave
Sunnyside Ave
York Dr

ZONE 3
Arbor Dr
Artuna Ave *
Blair Ave
(Below Highland)
Bonita Ave
(South of Park Way)
Cambridge Way
(East of Grand Ave)
Carmel Ave
Dale Ave
Dracena Ave
El Cerrito Ave
Fairview Ave
Grand Ave – *EVEN*
(Between Wildwood & Cambridge)
Greenbank Ave
(East of Grand Ave)
Highland Ave
(North of Mountain Ave)
Highland Way
Hill Lane *
Hillside Ave
Hillside Ct **(Hand Blow)*
Jerome Ave
Keefer Ct *
Larmer Ct *
Latham St
MacKinnon Pl *
Magnolia Ave
Moraga Ave
(West of Highland)
Nova Dr
Oakland Ave
(Between Grand & Highland)
Park View Ave
(Between Magnolia & 241 Park View)
Park Way
(Between Bonita & Highland)
Ricardo Ave
San Carlos Ave
Sylvan Way
Vista Ave
Waldo Ave

ZONE 4
Abbott Way *
Alta Ave
Bell Ave
Bellevue Ave
Blair Ave
(Above Highland)
Blair Place *
Calvert Ct
Craig Ave
Dormidera Ave
Dudley Ave
Dudley Ct *
Echo Lane *
Hagar Ave
Hardwick Ave
Langdon Ct *
Littlewood Dr
Maxwelton Rd
Mesa Ave
Monte Ave
Moraga Ave
(East of Highland)
Mountain Ave
(West of Sharon)
Nellie Ave *
Oakland Ave
(Between Highland & Scenic)
Pacific Ave
Pala Ave
Park Way
(Between Highland & Pala)
Scenic Ave
Sharon Ave
Sharon Ct

ZONE 5
Annerley Rd
Boulevard Way
Caperton Ave
Crocker Ave
(North of La Salle Ave)
Crofton Ave
Farragut Ave
Guilford Rd
Hampton Rd
(West of Sea View Ave)
Harvard Rd
Hazel Lane
Highland Ave
(South of Mountain Ave)
King Ave
Lakeview Ave
Lincoln Ave
Mountain Ave
(East of Sharon)
Oak Rd
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Palm Dr
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Prospect Rd
Ranleigh Way
Requa Pl
Requa Rd
Richardson Way
Sea View Ave
(Between Mountain & La Salle)
Sheridan Ave
Sierra Ave
Wallace Rd
Warfield Ave
Wildwood Ave
Winsor Ave

Subscribe to *Street Sweeping Email Updates* (https://lp.constantcontactpages.com/su/2tJcrMR/streetsweepalerts) to get reminders about upcoming street sweeping dates. The Piedmont Public Works Department sends out the weekly schedule to this list every Sunday during street sweeping season.

Street sweeping tips for residents

To help Piedmont's Department of Public Works keep the streets free of leaves during the fall and winter months, residents are asked to observe four rules:

1. Do not put branches in the street, even small branches! They damage the street sweeping equipment.
2. Do not sweep debris from your yard into the gutter – sweep only leaves that fall naturally into the street.
3. Sweep leaves into narrow rows outside the flow line of the gutter. Do not put them in piles. The street sweepers cannot pick up piles of leaves effectively.
4. If you want to rake your leaves, you can now add them to your weekly unlimited green waste cart. If you don't have enough room in your cart, free compostable bags are available at City Hall to place with your green cart on garbage day. Do not bag them and then empty the bags on the street on sweeping day. Compostable bags are also available from Republic Services (1-800-320-8077) for a fee.



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PPD Blue

Excerpts from the Piedmont Police Department Log

September 11 - 18

The Week by the Numbers

1 Arrest
1 Auto Burglary
1 Vandalism Report
1 Residential Burglary
2 Assaults
3 Fraud Reports
4 ALPRs triggered (Automatic License Plate Readers)

Friday, September 11

12:59 p.m. Highland Ave. **Assault.** Report of two kids in physical altercation in Piedmont Park. One with arm bleeding runs off toward PHS. Other party evaluated for head injury; relative arrives on scene. No medical transport or prosecution requested.

10:04 p.m. Estates Dr. **Fraud.** Report of wire fraud from Citibank account.

Saturday, September 12

11:40 a.m. Magnolia Ave. Report of bathroom door at pool unable to be unlocked. Officer finds lock broken, door opened, no one was stuck inside.

9:49 p.m. Hampton Rd. **ALPR** triggered by vehicle with lost or stolen plate. Officer makes contact, registered car owner replaced stolen plate and forgot to advise DMV.

Sunday, September 13

2:01 a.m. Palm Dr. **Assault. Arrest.** Verbal altercation that turns physical at liquor store on International Blvd. in Oakland. One male and three females followed by two men in Toyota Prius. Second physical altercation ensues at Winsor Ave. dead end. Male subject is pepper sprayed, struck in the head, and has wallet, chain and shoes stolen. Man taken to hospital. One female punched in the face. Suspects flee. One suspect is later identified and arrested for robbery, assault and vandalism. Some of victim's property recovered.

11:45 a.m. Moraga Ave. Officer finds white Toyota Avalon parked with ignition punched. Abandoned car marked for tow.

Monday, September 14

3:32 a.m. Park Blvd., Oakland. Silver Infiniti with temporary plates fails to yield to PD. Vehicle speeds away to Hwy 13 through four stop lights.

3:35 a.m. Hanly Rd., Oakland. Newer blue BMW speeding and occupied by two people fails to yield to police. No pursuit.

6:40 p.m. Oakland Ave. **ALPR** triggered by black Honda Civic with temporary plates.

9:41 p.m. Indian Rd. Report of man lying on ground. Medical assistance requested; man reports sharp pain in groin area. Subject taken to hospital.

Tuesday, September 15

5:21 p.m. Mountain Ave. **Residential Burglary.** Report of package containing credit cards stolen from top of mailbox.

5:50 p.m. Magnolia Ave. **Fraud.** Report of fraud charges on credit card.

Wednesday, September 16

7:50 a.m. Grand Ave. Report of man sitting on ground talking to himself. Officer makes contact and gives person courtesy ride.

9:32 a.m. Estates Dr. **ALPR** triggered by vehicle with switched rear plate. Officer spots vehicle, front plate matches VIN. Registered owner called and informed.

1:18 p.m. Cambridge Way. Report of attempt to vandalize vehicle. Officer finds verbal altercation, no crime.

4:29 p.m. Palm Dr. **Fraud.** Report of fraud.

Thursday, September 17

9:40 a.m. St. James Dr. **Vandalism.** Report of black Toyota Land Cruiser rifled through and possible damage to ignition.

1:38 p.m. Marlborough Ct. **Auto Burglary.** Report of suspect in red Acura stealing tools from parked Dodge Ram.

Friday, September 18

2:59 a.m. Grand Ave. **ALPR** triggered by black Honda sedan. Driver wearing black mask driving at high speed. No pursuit.

PICKS OF THE WEEK (2)

• *How a bus does a wheelie*
Friday, September 11

3:18 p.m. El Cerrito Ave. Report of visiting football team bus stuck at entrance to Witter Field. Bus on three wheels. Bus not blocking road, tow truck clears hazard.

• *Too early for Santa*
Friday, September 18

8:56 a.m. Linda Ave. Report of gardeners on the roof using gas-powered leaf blower. Gardeners advised of PCO.



"The ideal solution would be for the Post Office to run the IRS, and Dude to run the Post Office.

Sports

Girls' volleyball team falls to Berkeley in WACC opener

By Jonathan Comeaux

Piedmont High's girls' volleyball team suffered a 3-1 loss to Berkeley at Binks Rawlings Gym on Thursday, September 17. It was the Highlanders' first match against a Western Alameda County Conference Foothill Division opponent, bringing their record to 11-7 overall.

Although it marked the Highlanders' third straight 3-1 loss, Berkeley is a perennial contender for the Foothill title and reached last year's D1 North Coast Section semifinals. Despite the loss, Piedmont was within striking distance in each set.

"To have Berkeley on the ropes is incredible. We're super proud of what we're doing and figured out things that were working well for us. I feel like we easily could've taken that to five sets," co-coach Jason Mongue said.



Staff Photos

Piedmont fell 3-1 to Berkeley for its WACC Foothill league opener.



Carina Vora had 16 assists against the Yellowjackets.

Piedmont is passing the midway mark of the season and looking to secure its second straight North Coast Section berth. Mongue previously said that he's looking for the team to play with a fast pace.

"It's definitely tough, but I think it's working a lot better, especially with our outside hitters. In the beginning, we played some easier teams and the harder teams like Berkeley is definitely a challenge. But it's lifting our level as well, and our connection to our hitters is getting better," sophomore setter Carina Vora said.

"The tempo of our sets has gotten more consistent; just trusting everyone to get the right tempo and do the right steps to

See Girls' Volleyball on page 29

Piedmont wins one of four at Vintage Valley Tournament

By Jonathan Comeaux

Piedmont High's boys' water polo team won one of four matches at the Vintage Valley Tournament at Vintage HS in Napa on Friday and Saturday, September 18-19. All three losses were separated by two goals or less; they fell 9-8 to Clayton Valley Charter and beat Marin Catholic 11-8 on the opening day, while losing 12-10 to Sequoia and 12-11 to San Marin the following day.

The batch of results brings the Highlanders' record to 5-6 overall with eight matches left in the regular season.

It was a strong tournament for junior Henry Stein, who had 24 goals over the four-match span, including nine goals in their 12-11 loss to San Marin. Goalie Dylan Jerez was also instrumental in keeping the matches close, recording 35 saves throughout the tourney.

Official quarter-by-quarter score lines were not provided for the tournament matches.



Staff Photos

The boys' water polo team won one of four matches at the Vintage Valley Tournament in Napa.

9-8 loss to Clayton Valley Charter

Piedmont fell 9-8 in the opening match of the tournament. Clayton Valley led 4-0 through the first quarter and 6-2 by halftime. Then, Piedmont roared back in the third quarter with four unanswered goals to knot things up at 6-6 going into the final period. . However the Ugly Eagles outscored the Highlanders 3-2 in the fourth to win it.

Final stats: Stein led with five goals and three assists. Rylan Patty had two goals, two assists, and two steals. Dylan Jerez finished with 11 saves, two steals, an assist, and scored once as a goalie.

11-8 win vs. Marin Catholic

The Highlanders claimed its only win of the tournament 11-8 over Marin Catholic in their second match.

Final stats: Stein had five goals and two assists. Patty had five goals, one assist, and one steal. Henry Van Den Bos had one goal and an assist. Oliver Hurwitz had one assist and one steal. Graham Smith had two steals. Travers Kemp had one steal. Raffi Banin had one assist. Jerez had six saves, four steals, and two assists.

12-10 loss to Sequoia

Piedmont returned on Saturday and lost a narrow 12-10 battle to Sequoia.

See Boys' Water Polo on page 31

The double life of student-athletes

By Julia Stokes

Waking up before sunrise for practice. Carrying two backpacks from class to class. Finishing homework in the backseat of a car on the way to an away game. For student-athletes at Piedmont High School, the school day doesn't always end when the final bell rings.

Practices, games, and workouts can last well into the evening, leaving athletes scrambling to find time for schoolwork whenever they can.

Water polo player senior Raffaello Banin said managing school work during the water polo season can be difficult, especially when games and practices take up much of the day. "I try to be super efficient overall when I have time to work and sometimes get homework done in the car on the way to games," Banin said.

For some athletes, that efficiency means less free time to relax. Basketball player senior Taylor White said her schedule requires her to fit schoolwork in whenever she gets the opportunity.

"Managing school and a sport can be a challenge sometimes, but mostly I do my homework during my free periods, in the car while going home, and sometimes I set my alarm to wake up early in the morning to catch up on anything I missed," White said.

The challenge can become more complicated for athletes who compete outside of PHS. Many student-athletes participate in club sports, adding another layer to an already busy schedule.

For volleyball player junior Olivia Stevens, the timing of the school and club seasons helps make the commitments more manageable.

"School season is August-October and club is November-May, so it works out," Stevens said. "For beach volleyball, it's harder because it's spring season and it overlaps [with club], but it's still manageable."

Even when seasons do not directly overlap, the workload can be exhausting. White said club basketball is more laid back than her school season, but travel can make it demanding. During school basketball season, practices and workouts can add another physical challenge to the school day.

"The school days can be tiring after a workout from the previous day," White said. "Since we have workouts right after school, it just depends on my mood. But other than that, school season is exciting."

Despite the time commitment, athletes said their sports provide experiences that make the busy schedules worthwhile.

For Banin, one of the biggest differences between club and school sports is the connection among teammates. Knowing teammates from school already creates a stronger sense of community.

"School sports is a bigger commitment [than club sports], but the team is also more connected because we see each other every day," Banin said. "Club is good though, because you meet new people and it's fun."

White said basketball has given her the opportunity to build relationships while also competing against high-level competition athletes from around the country.

"The experience and opportunity to travel across the country playing against some of the best competition and future college players is really exciting. I get to see how I match up against some of the best players," White said.

For PHS student-athletes, balancing academics and athletics often requires fitting study sessions and homework in whenever there is time , and achieving success both as an athlete and as a student requires physical and mental strength. The sacrifices that athletes make show up both in the classroom and on the field, the court, or the pool.

Julia Stokes is a junior at Piedmont High School and a student writer intern for the Piedmont Post.

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PHS cross-country team runs at De La Salle Nike Invitational

By Jonathan Comeaux

Piedmont High's cross country team traveled to Newhall Community Park in Concord for the 2026 De La Salle Nike Invitational on Saturday, September 19. The Highlanders' boys' team finished 22nd of 31 schools, while the girls were 18th of 22.

"The De La Salle Nike Invitational was our third meet of the season and another opportunity to see how our runners are progressing as we start to head into the middle of the season. We are still only in September. We are continuing to train, build durability and learn how to race," explained coach Steve Zirkelbach.

"The objective isn't to be at our best right now—it is to keep progressing so that we are running our best when the important championship meets arrive later in the season. Saturday gave us another encouraging indication that we are moving in the right direction."

Junior runner Dresden Schulte-Sasse led PHS for the third straight meet. He finished 50th of 204 athletes with a time of 17:06.9 on the three-mile course.

"Dresden led Piedmont over the three-mile course, becoming our No. 3 junior performance by a Piedmont runner at Newhall Community Park. Dresden gave us another strong performance at the front of the boys' varsity team," Zirkelbach said.

Behind Schulte-Sasse was senior Alex Schleuning placing 99th with a time of 17:45.1. Junior Luca LaForte was 140th in 18:32, sophomore Blake Riif was 162nd in 19:07.6, while sophomore Rohan Seshan rounded out their best five runners in 164th, clocking a 19:13.8.



Dresden Schulte-Sasse led Piedmont's boys' team for the third straight meet.

"Alex Schleuning was our second finisher, followed by Luca LaForte. Blake Riiff continued his strong start to the season, and Rohan Seshan completed our scoring five. Our collective time of 91:45.4 was the No. 2 Piedmont varsity boys' team performance at Newhall Park," Zirkelbach said.

The girls continue to run without marquee runners Leighton Mand, Amalia Gray, and Kelsey Coleman. Junior runner Viviane Oesterer led the girls' side, finishing 76th of 167 with a time of 21:13.7.

"The front of our girls' varsity group ran particularly well. Viviane Oesterer led Piedmont with a very good time for the three-mile course. She improved her previous Newhall Park best by approximately eight seconds and moved to No. 4 on Piedmont's junior list at the event," Zirkelbach said.

Senior Cora Brozowski Schrader was next in for the Highlanders, placing 82nd, clocking a 21:24.1. Junior Nikita Gorelik was 96th in 21:45.3, sophomore Camille Hauser came in 120th in 22:55.7, while senior Annie Thornton rounded out their five scorers in 144th, 24:32.9.

"Just behind Viviane was Cora Brozowski Schrader. Cora's performance ranks No. 2 among Piedmont seniors at Newhall Park. Nikita Gorelik gave us a third runner near the front. That put Viviane, Cora and Nikita within approximately 32 seconds of one another. Developing that kind of grouping at the front of the team will be increasingly important as we move farther into the season," Zirkelbach said.

NEXT UP

Piedmont has 11 days of rest before its first Western Alameda County Conference meet of the season on Wednesday, September 30 at Point Pinole Regional Park at 3:30 p.m.



Alex Schleuning was the boys' second best runner at the De La Salle Invitational.



Viviane Oesterer (right) and Cora Brozowksi Schrader (left) were PHS' top two female runners at the De La Salle Invitational.

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PHS coach Jim Landes hosting fall middle school tennis through Oct. 22

Clinics run as follows:

- **Beginner level**
  Wednesdays – 7:00 p.m. to 8:30 p.m.
- **Intermediate/Advanced level**
  Tuesday/Thursdays – 7:00 p.m. to 8:30 p.m.

There is flexibility about which evening to attend, meaning beginner level players can still attend on Tuesdays and Thursdays, while Intermediate/Advance level athletes can also attend Wednesdays. Athletes can sign up for one, two, or three sessions per week.

Provided here is a registration link (register.capturepoint.com/reg/cat_program_class_detail.cfm?s=&t=&season_id=24069&program_id=1488320&family_mbr_str=) for *Post* web users.

Girls' tennis team bashes Berkeley 6-1 in league opener

By Jonathan Comeaux

The Highlanders' girls' tennis team got its Western Alameda County Conference schedule started in a big way, dominating rival Berkeley 6-1 at the Corey Reich Tennis Center on Wednesday, September 16. PHS fell 4-3 to North Coast Section competitor Lick-Wilmerding in San Francisco the previous day, September 15.

Wednesday's win over the Yellowjackets was a good display by the No. 1 doubles duo of Emma Chan and Chiara Silvio, claiming the school's first win of the day in a 6-4, 6-0 victory. Chan is in her third varsity year and second straight year as the team's No. 1 doubles starter after appearing alongside Samantha Huynh last season.

"Because Chiara and I are really good friends, it's easy have a connection on the court and coordinate our shots. I don't need to tell her where to go, she'll already be there. Obviously, like any new partner, it takes some adjusting to. At this point of the season, we're getting more comfortable and coordinated," Chan said.

"We played a lot together growing up and we have good chemistry. I don't have to worry about what she's going to do next," Silvio said.

Silvio did well at the net against Berkeley, converting many smashes and volleys for points.

"It's been really nice because I can rely on Emma to be really aggressive. I think my net-play has gotten a lot better, I've gotten more comfortable and confident there," Silvio said.

"Her net play is great," said Chan. "When Chiara gets her racket on the ball at the net, it's really effective,".

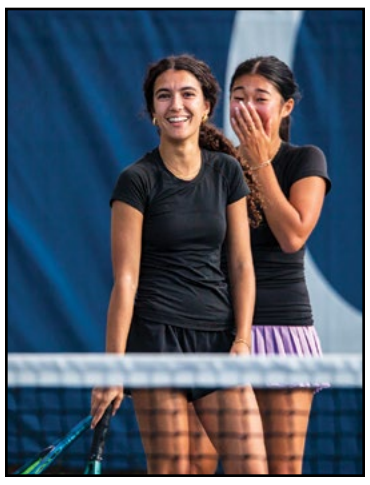
The Berkeley win was an impressive display by freshman Maddy Huynh, moving up to the No. 2 singles spot with usual starter Faith Chin out. Huynh dominated in a clean sweep, 6-0, 6-0.

"With Faith out we moved up Maddy. She has been really good and we have a lot of belief in her. She's already a great player and is going to get even better," said coach Jim Landes.

6-1 win over Berkeley

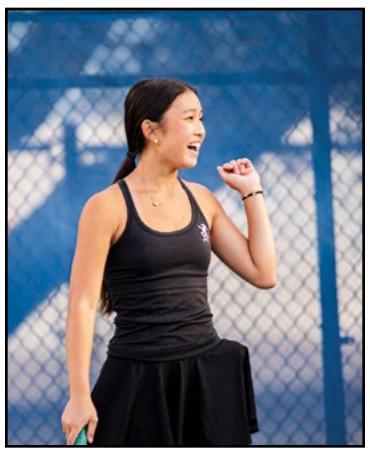
Winning the first match of the day was the No. 1 doubles duo of Chan and Silvio. Leela Sivakumar quickly followed with a 6-0, 6-1 win at the No. 3 singles spot, while Ella Ruthven at the No. 1 singles spot won 6-1, 6-3 to five Piedmont its third win.

Maddy Huynh clinched the day at No. 2 singles in her shutout victory, giving PHS its fourth win. After that, Berkeley got its only win of the day at No. 4 singles, where Ella Sharafi lost 6-4, 7-6 (7-5).



Staff Photos

Chiara Silvio (left) and Emma Chan locked down a 6-4, 6-0 win at No. 1 doubles against Berkeley.



Maddy Huynh, a freshman, moved up to No. 2 singles against Berkeley, winning in a 6-0, 6-0 clean sweep.

Finishing the day was Ella Thomasson and Paige Chin winning 6-1, 6-4 at No. 2 doubles, while Penelope Welch and Mai Pham won 6-3, 6-2 at No. 3 doubles.

4-3 loss to Lick-Wilmerding

Piedmont won one of four matches at singles with Faith Chin winning a barn burner in three sets at the No. 2 spot by scores of 6-3, 3-6, 10-8. Ella Ruthven lost 6-3, 6-0 at No. 1, Huynh lost a close match No. 3 in three sets by scores of 7-6 (9-7), 2-6, 10-4, while Sivakumar lost 6-2, 6-2 at No. 4.

At doubles, PHS won two of three matches. Paige Chin and Thomasson won 6-2, 6-0 at No. 2, while Layla Reed-Miguel and Katie Pham won 6-3, 6-1 at No. 3. Chan and Silvio lost 6-0, 6-1 at the No. 1 spot.

NEXT UP

Piedmont (6-2 overall, 1-0 league) hosts Marin Academy today, September 23, at 3:30 p.m. They also visit Bishop O'Dowd at Merritt College on Thursday, September 24 at the same time.



Leela Sivakumar returns a ball against Berkeley. She won 6-0, 6-1 at No. 3 singles.

Piedmont struggles through injuries in 40-14 loss to Aragon

By Jonathan Comeaux

Piedmont High's football team took a one-sided 40-14 loss to Aragon for Homecoming Night on Friday, September 18 at Witter Field. The result brings their record to 1-3.

The Highlanders were dealing with several important injuries to starters going into the game. They were without running back Rehan Mumtaz, receiver and safety Diego Hurwitz, linebacker Max Fujimoto, cornerback Owen Curran, and starting linebacker and receiver Mason Gray left the game with an injury.

"We had a lot of people out, but the effort was there. Our numbers are low and we have to get some bodies back. You see how it played out; those are all great players for us and heavy contributing starters. I was just hoping to get through this game healthy, but that's football," coach Jordan Seiden said.

PHS' young roster faced growing pains, including sophomore quarterback Cyrus Emanuelson tossing some interceptions. He was able to respond well in the game's final drive, leading the Highlanders to a touchdown.

"One thing about Cyrus that I love is he is unflappable. He shakes things off and is on to the next play. Being a young quarterback, he could've easily gone into a hole and tanked, but not Cyrus. He has a huge heart and loves the game, he's just going to continue to grow. My message to him is to just keep growing and keep getting better. That's the same with the rest of the team," Seiden said.



Mateo Long scoring a touchdown for Piedmont.



George Saunders reaches for a ball against Aragon. He scored Piedmont's final touchdown.



Staff photos

Piedmont suffered a rough 40-14 loss to the Aragon with a bulk of its starters missing due to injuries.

Game Recap

After a scoreless first quarter, Aragon scored on a 12-play, 71-yard series. They converted a 4th-and-goal from the four to make it 6-0 with 11:10 left in the second quarter following a missed extra point.

Piedmont scored on its ensuing possession with an eight-play, 72 yard drive. It featured 37-yard pass from Cyrus Emanuelson to Gray on 3rd-and-10 from their own 45. After that, Colby Hong ran the ball 18 yards, while Emanuelson threw a 10-yard touchdown pass to Mateo Long with 8:15 on the clock. A missed two-point conversion kept it deadlocked at 6-6.

PHS had good field position after Henry Brennan recovered a fumble at Aragon's 45, but Piedmont turned over on downs after gaining just four yards. From there, AHS blew the game open with 34 unanswered points. They scored twice more in the second quarter to lead 20-6 at the half, and extended to 40-6 with an interception return for a touchdown with 2:37 left in the fourth quarter.

Piedmont's final touchdown came with 1:12 remaining in the game. Starting at their own 42, the drive started with a 33 yard pass to George Saunders. On 2nd-and-10, Saunders took a 17-yard reception to the eight, and then connected with Emanuelson again for an eight-yard touchdown catch. Hong ran the ball in for a successful two-point conversion for a final score of 40-14.

NEXT UP

Piedmont (1-3 overall) visits Moreau Catholic in Hayward on Friday, September 25 at 7:00 p.m.

PIEDMONT SPORTS SCHEDULE

Some events subject to change. (Revised - 9/23/26)

Date	Day	Sport	Opponent	Loc.	Var.	JV.
Sep. 23	Wed.	TEN	Marin Academy	H/A	3:30	3:30
		GG	Alameda, Bishop O'Dowd at Chuck Corica (Alameda)	A	3:30	3:30
		VB	Bishop O'Dowd (Oakland)	A	6:30	5:30
Sep. 24	Thurs.	TEN	Bishop O'Dowd at Merritt College (Oakland)	A/H	3:30	3:30
		WP-B	Encinal	H	6:00	5:00
		FF	Mt. Eden	H	7:30	6:30
Sep. 25	Fri.	FB	Moreau Catholic (Hayward)	A	7:00	4:00
Sep. 29	Tues.	TEN	College Prep	H/A	3:30	3:30
		WP-B	Berkeley	A	4:00	5:00
		FF	San Leandro	A	6:00	5:00
		VB	Encinal (Alameda)	A	6:45	5:45
Sep. 30	Wed.	TEN	Head-Royce	H/A	3:30	3:30
		XC	WACC Meet at Point Pinole Park	A	3:30	3:30
		GG	Arroyo	A	3:30	3:30

KEY: H = Home, A = Away, XC = Cross Country, FB = Football, FF = Flag Football, VB = Girls' Volleyball, WP-B = Boys' Water Polo, TEN = Girls' Tennis, GG = Girls' Golf

Flag football team demolishes San Lorenzo 46-0

By Jonathan Comeaux

Piedmont High's flag football team came away with a one-sided 46-0 shutout of San Lorenzo on Thursday, September 17 at Witter Field. The result marked its third win in four games, bringing their record to 5-5 and 3-1 against Western Alameda County Conference opponents.

"The offense is coming along and the defense is improving every game. I think tonight was a good correction from our last loss, and the girls never wanted to leave the field," said coach Beth Black.

It was a strong game all-around for the Highlanders, logging six interceptions on the night by Sydney Latvala, Cory Minor, Maddie Lee, Skye Prata Baack, and two by Bea Nackley.

"We're forcing turnovers and we showed we're hungry for the ball," Black said.

Prata Baack had a productive game with a touchdown reception and a one-point conversion on five receptions. She broke catches of 21-, 29-, 15-, and 12-yards.

"It's my first year playing, so it was hard to adjust in the beginning. Now, as a team, we've had so much time together and we're feeling that connection. We're able to execute, the energy was really good tonight. Getting to know each other and learn our styles of play is really helping," Prata Baack said.

Game Recap

Piedmont's Sydney Latvala recorded an interception on the second play of the game. Prata Baack then took a 21-yard reception to the Grizzlies' five, but SLZ was able to nab an interception of its own. After forcing a punt, PHS got its first score of the game with 47 seconds left in the first quarter with an eight-play, 66-yard drive. It capped off with a nine-yard touchdown pass from Edie Elmquist to Cea'naiya Alexander on a corner route, making it 7-0 after a successful one-point conversion on a pass to Agatha Filha Gama.

Bea Nackley grabbed an interception on San Lorenzo's next drive, returning it to the one 18 seconds into the second quarter. On second down, Elmquist took a keeper up the middle for the touchdown with 10:26 left, making it 13-0 after an unsuccessful conversion.

PHS' defense forced a three-and-out, leading to six-play, 45 yard drive that resulted in a 19-yard touchdown run by Mafi, who also converted the one-point try on a run to make it 20-0 with 4:07 left in the half. Another three-and-out gave Piedmont a short field at the SLZ 31 with 1:46 remaining. After a 16-yard run by Elmquist, she hit Prata Baack for a 15-yard touchdown pass with 1:08 left. Elmquist converted the one-point try to make it 27-0.

See Flag Football on page 31



Staff Photos

Skye Prata Baack celebrates a touchdown reception against San Lorenzo.



Bea Nackley made two interceptions against San Lorenzo.



Nea Mafi runs in a touchdown against the Grizzlies.

JV Highlanders rally past Aragon in second-half comeback



Photos by Graham Smith

Piedmont captains Ernie Hildreth (#6), Jeb Burden (#29), Alex Covian (#69) and Keliti Havea (#72) led the Highlanders to a 22-7 win over Aragon.

By Ernie Hildreth

The Piedmont Highlander JV team defeated Aragon 22-7 Friday, September 18, overcoming a 7-6 halftime deficit with a strong second half on both sides of the ball. Led by their four captains, the Highlanders shut down Aragon's offense and took control after halftime.

Aragon's only points came on a first-half interception return. Piedmont's defense held the Dons scoreless for the rest of the game, forcing four turnovers and making plays whenever Aragon threatened.

Gael Fierro gave the Highlanders a big boost with two interceptions, including a pick-six that gave Piedmont momentum. His second interception helped keep Aragon from getting anything going through the air. Fierro was awarded the team's turnover chain after the game.

Piedmont's defensive line played a big part in the win, controlling the line of scrimmage and creating lanes for the linebackers to attack. The defensive backs also played physical and limited Aragon's passing game.

The Highlanders' offensive line had one of its best games of the season. They handled four-man fronts, five-man fronts and blitzing linebackers while opening holes for the running game and giving the quarterbacks time to throw. Quarterback Gio Lopez connected with Fierro on several deep passes, helping keep Piedmont's passing game going. The Highlanders finished with more than 100 rushing yards and over

See JV Football on page 29



Gael Fierro (#15) and Keliti Havea (#72) celebrate recording a pick-six against the Dons.



Gael Fierro (#15) on his way to the end zone after an interception.

Athletes of the Week: Edie Elmquist, Henry Stein

Honorable Mention: Viviane Oesterer, Dresden Schulte-Sasse

By Jonathan Comeaux

We're awarding Edie Elmquist of flag football and Henry Stein of boys' water polo our Athletes of the Week. Our honorable mentions go to Viviane Oesterer of girls' cross country and Dresden Schulte-Sasse of boys' cross country.



Staff Photos

Edie Elmquist earns Athlete of the Week for her multiple touchdown performance in Piedmont's 47-0 win over San Lorenzo.

EDIE ELMQUIST

Edie Elmquist earns Athletes of the Week for her multi-touchdown performance in Piedmont's dominant 47-0 win over San Lorenzo. As a quarterback, she logged touchdown passes of nine and 15 yards, while also scoring twice on touchdown carries. She also scored a one-point conversion via a quarterback keeper up the middle.



Henry Stein earns Athlete of the Week for scoring 24 goals at the Vintage Valley Tournament.

HENRY STEIN

Henry Stein earns Athlete of the Week after leading Piedmont High's boys' water polo team in scoring with 24 total goals over a four-match span at the Vintage Valley Tournament. He also logged seven assists and three steals. Stein scored five goals in Piedmont's 9-8 loss to Clayton Valley, their 12-10 loss to Sequoia, and their 11-8 win over Marin Catholic, along with a tournament-high of nine goals in their 12-11 loss to San Marin.

Honorable Mentions

Viviane Oesterer gets an honorable mention for leading the girls' cross country team through a rash of injuries. In their recent De La Salle Nike Invitational, Oesterer was Piedmont's lead runner by finishing 76th of 167 runners with a time of 21:13.7. She's led Piedmont in its last two events.

Dresden Schulte-Sasse earns an honorable mention for being the boys' cross country team's leader through each of its first three events of the season. At the De La Salle Nike Invitational, Schulte-Sasse finished 50th of 204 athletes with a time of 17:06.9.



Viviane Oesterer earns an honorable mention for leading the girls' cross country team at the De La Salle Nike Invitational.



Dresden Schulte-Sasse gets an honorable mention for leading the boys' cross country team for the third straight week.

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Arts & Entertainment

Los Tranquilos perform at OMCA this Friday



Los Tranquilos

By Allyson Aleksey

Nipomo-based band Los Tranquilos perform at Oakland Museum of California (OMCA) this Friday.

The free concert is part of the museum's Friday Nights series. OMCA hosts free community events every Friday at 5 p.m. throughout the year, featuring live music, immersive arts activities and late-night museum access with the purchase of a museum ticket.

The band Los Tranquilos features brother duo Manny and JJ Martinez, as well as longtime friend Cameron Porter. Established in the summer of 2022, Los Tranquilos create both universal and historical tracks with sounds heavily inspired by 60s and 70s "romanticas" soul, psychedelia from Mexico and Latin America.

The event continues in the museum's amphitheater with Caja Mágica's all-vinyl DJ set, featuring a vibrant selection of Latin American records from the '60s and '70s across a range of genres. Visitors can also connect with Bike East Bay in the museum garden to learn more about the organization's efforts to create safer, more accessible streets throughout the East Bay.

Bring a blanket and lawn chairs to relax on the museum's large lawn, where live music and entertainment takes place throughout the evening. Guests can bring their own food and refreshments or purchase from a stationed food truck on-site. A rotating list of vendors will be parked on 10th Street between Oak and Fallon Streets adjacent to the museum. No outside alcohol is permitted.

Visit https://museumca.org/ to learn more.

Berkeley Playhouse presents *Legally Blonde The Musical* now through Oct. 11

By Allyson Aleksey

Berkeley Playhouse opens its 2026-27 season with *Legally Blonde The Musical*, based on the popular 2001 film, running now through October 11.

The production stars Ayani Dorsey as Elle Woods, a sorority president who enrolls at Harvard Law School after being dumped by her boyfriend and ultimately proves herself while working on a case.

No'eau Kahalekulu directs the production, with choreography by Cat Delos Santos Reyes and music direction by Camden Daly. The production features a 25-person company of Bay Area performers.

"If you loved this movie in 2001, I promise it's even more fun with a live band and an audience. The show moves at a whip fast pace and is full of laughs and seriously impressive dance and vocals," said Kimberly Dooley, Artistic Director of Berkeley Playhouse. "*Legally Blonde* defies stereotypes and celebrates female teamwork, empowerment and above all else ... authenticity."

Kahalekulu said the character of Elle Woods has remained a favorite since the film's release.

"Elle Woods has been my comfort character since 2001. If she can get into Harvard and keep her sparkle, the rest of us can handle whatever's in front of us," said director No'eau Kahalekulu. "We've all gotten a little scared to be big and silly and sincere in public lately. This production is an invitation back into it. Like the show says, being true to yourself never goes out of style."

Scenic design is by Sarah Phykitt, with costumes by Ashley Renee and lighting by Sophia Craven. The musical is based on the novel *Legally Blonde* by Amanda Brown and the 2001 film of the same name.

The cast also includes two dogs: Latke the Pomeranian, making a theatrical debut as Bruiser Woods, and Stella, a three-year-old French bulldog mix, as Rufus.

Tickets are available through Berkeley Playhouse online at https://berkeleyplayhouse.org/.



The production stars Ayani Dorsey as Elle Woods.

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A.C.T. presents *North by Northwest* now through Oct. 18



Photo courtesy of American Conservatory Theater
The cast includes Danny Collins as Thornhill.

By Allyson Aleksey

American Conservatory Theater (A.C.T.) opens its 2026-27 season with a theatrical adaptation of Alfred Hitchcock's *North by Northwest*, showing onstage now through October 18.

The production is adapted and directed by Emma Rice. Rice previously directed A.C.T.'s *Brief Encounter* and Berkeley Repertory Theatre's *The Wild Bride*.

Rice's production uses seven performers, live music, movement and theatrical effects to tell the story of Roger Thornhill, an advertising executive who is mistaken for a Cold War spy and forced to flee across the country.

The production features a 1950s-inspired soundtrack and a theatrical recreation of the film's famous Mount Rushmore sequence. The cast includes Danny Collins as Thornhill, Evangeline Dickson as Mrs. Townsend and understudy, Patrycja Kujawska as Eve Kendall and others, Simon Oskarsson as Valerian and others, Katy Owen as the Professor and others, Bryony Pennington as Anna and others, and Karl Queensborough as Phillip Vandamm and others. Sam Archer will take over the role of Valerian and others beginning October 10.

"What makes Emma Rice's *North by Northwest* so exhilarating is that it isn't trying to recreate Hitchcock's film frame for frame," said Andy Chan Donald, A.C.T.'s artistic producing director and acting artistic director. "Instead, it captures the wit, suspense, and cinematic scale of the original while embracing everything that makes live theater extraordinary."

"The result is a production that honors a beloved classic while becoming something entirely its own — a thrilling reminder that the stage can be every bit as breathtaking as the silver screen," Donald added.

The original *North by Northwest*, starring Cary Grant and Eva Marie Saint, follows Thornhill as he is pursued across the country after being mistaken for a government agent. Directed by Hitchcock and released in 1959, the film is widely regarded as one of the director's major works.

North by Northwest will run at A.C.T.'s Toni Rembe Theater now through October 18.

Post-show conversations are scheduled for September 29, October 4 and 7. Pride Night will take place October 7, with an open-captioned performance on October 10. A tasting event is scheduled for October 6, and PlayTime, an interactive theater workshop, will take place before the October 17 matinee.

Visit https://www.act-sf.org/ to purchase tickets.

SF Opera and orchestra reach tentative contract agreement

By Allyson Aleksey

The San Francisco Opera and San Francisco Opera Orchestra jointly announced last week that they have reached a tentative agreement on a new four-year contract.

The agreement, reached on September 17 after a week of negotiating by both parties, spans August 1, 2026 through July 31, 2030 and is still subject to ratification, according to the company.

The orchestra strike forced the cancellation of the September 12 opening-night performance of *Simon Boccanegra*, as well as the annual free Opera in the Park concert scheduled for September 13. The musicians' strike also postponed the company's annual fundraiser to November.

San Francisco Opera's 104th season opened this Tuesday, September 22, with Giuseppe Verdi's *Simon Boccanegra*. Thea Musgrave's *Mary, Queen of Scots* opens tomorrow, Thursday, September 24, in a new co-production directed by Stewart Laing and led by debuting conductor Clelia Cafiero.

"I am deeply grateful that we have reached a tentative agreement on a new contract, one that addresses important structural changes while providing a fair agreement for our Musicians," San Francisco Opera General Director Matthew Shilvock said in a press release.

"We look forward to welcoming our talented company members and guest artists, as well as our cherished patrons and donors, back to the theater. Most of all, we look forward to coming together again and reconnecting through the collective beauty of the arts," Shilvock added.

For more information about San Francisco Opera's 2026–27 season, visit www.sfopera.com.

Haines Gallery explores Indigenous futures in new group exhibition



***250 Years, Indigenous Futures* installation view** *Photo courtesy of Haines Gallery*

By Allyson Aleksey

Haines Gallery at San Francisco's Fort Mason presents *250 Years, Indigenous Futures*, a group exhibition featuring work by eight Native American artists.

The exhibition features Victoria Grace Canby, Jordan Ann Craig, Sky Hopinka, Brad Kahlhamer, Terran Last Gun, Jamie Okuma, Wendy Red Star and Keith Secola. The artists work across painting, drawing, sculpture, photography and film.

The works draw from a wide range of sources, including Piikani painted lodges, Northern Cheyenne beadwork, the 1969-71 occupation of Alcatraz Island by the Indians of All Tribes, the annual Crow Fair, horror films and archival photography.

Among the artists featured is Marin-based Victoria Grace Canby, whose new works on paper depict the Three Sisters — corn, beans and squash — as a model of resilience, healing and collective care. Jordan Ann Craig's paintings combine references to Northern Cheyenne beadwork and quillwork with the work of modernist painter Agnes Martin.

Sky Hopinka's film *Sunflower Siege Engine* connects the occupation of Alcatraz with Cahokia Mounds in Illinois, while Brad Kahlhamer's *Pima Air + Space* features birds, horses and masked figures rendered in acrylic, ink and pencil on a bedsheet.

Terran Last Gun created a series of works inspired by the geometric designs of Piikani painted lodges, while Jamie Okuma's *Of Love and Sacrifice: Motherhood* combines intricate Payómkawichum (Luiseño) beadwork with imagery from the 2018 horror film *Suspiria*.

The exhibition takes its title from the writings of Standing Rock Sioux historian Philip J. Deloria and his colleagues, who have argued for understanding Native peoples through "the lens of futurity." The exhibition similarly considers Indigenous creativity and knowledge as active forces shaping contemporary life and the future.

Haines Gallery, a resident of Fort Mason since 2022, is dedicated to providing a platform for emerging and internationally established artists from Africa, Asia, Europe, the Middle East, North and South America.

250 Years, Indigenous Futures is on view now through Saturday, November 7, 2026 at Haines Gallery located in Building C, on the first floor of the Fort Mason Center for Arts and Culture. Admission is free.

Visit https://fortmason.org/event/haines-gallery-250-years-indigenous-futures/2026-09-22/ to learn more.

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The Musical Gourmet

A greatly gifted violinist

By Joseph Gold

It's kind of fun trying to be anonymous. Ogden Nash was convinced that it's kind of fun to be extinct. I'm not sure that I agree with him on that one. But being anonymous is lots of fun. Especially if you are a music critic. You get to eavesdrop on conversations and ask innocent questions pretending that you don't know very much.

I had intended to write an article about being anonymous. That idea changed on Sunday afternoon during the violin recital of Marcio Candido.

His violin recital in the Piedmont Center for the Arts was a one-man show devoted entirely to the unaccompanied violin sonatas of J.S. Bach.

Candido is a very friendly person and possesses enthusiasm and a love for his art. He expresses these things musically and verbally.

The solo sonatas of Johann Sebastian Bach are regarded as the Old Testament of violin music. They are indispensable. Candido began his program with Bach's monumental *Partita No. 2*. Modern violinists approach music in general as if music is an antiseptic art. They strive for perfection. In spite of their perfection, their approach lacks the human element.

Candido comes from a different school entirely. From the moment he places his bow on the strings of his violin, the music comes to life.

No composer in the history of music had more rhythm than Johann Sebastian Bach. His music must dance. It doesn't need a thump thump thump beat, but it must have a beat that conveys rhythm in a dancing way. When Marcio Candido plays Bach, it comes to life. His concept is expansive. The tone is always beautiful, and the musical lines are always clearly delineated. The tempos are relaxed, but at the same time they are intimate and rhythmic. While his interpretations are unique and individual, he makes everything work musically speaking.



Violinist Marcio Candido presented a solo violin concert at the PCA. He is a greatly gifted artist.

The audience was receptive to everything the violinist played. Of particular interest was the movement known as the chaconne. Toward the middle of the movement the tonality changes from minor to the major key. When it returns to the minor key, violinists do not know what to do. Simply stated, the transition is very difficult. But miracle of miracles, Candido found a brilliant solution. In retrospect, the solution was very logical.

The transition worked its way into a grand conclusion. This alone made the concert gratifying. Marcio Candido is a greatly gifted artist.

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Welcome to the Piedmont Center for the Arts

Saturday, September 26 – November 1
Oakland Art Association gallery show

Oakland Art Association presents *Hopes and Dreams*, a curated show that encompasses everyone's most precious and intimate desires for the future. It can be a dream vacation, a dream come true, a dream for the future of the world or just your part of it. Hope knows no bounds, hope for change, for healing, a brighter future, or for world peace. OAA is a non-profit group of artists, photographers, and art supporters in Alameda and Contra Costa Counties whose mission is to encourage artistic endeavor in the community, support public school art education, and arrange show venues for our members' artworks. The Opening Reception will be from 1:00 – 4:00 p.m. on Saturday, September 26, free and open to all. For more information, see www.oaklandart.org.

Saturday, September 26, 6:00 p.m.
Ezequiel Barrera and Carl Blake piano recital

As part of his residency in the SF Bay Area, virtuoso pianist and composer **Ezequiel Sebastian Barrera** from Mexico City will perform a recital, assisted by local pianist **Carl Blake** in a performance of Barrera's *Fantasia Mexicana* for one piano-four hands. Ezequiel has performed extensively to critical acclaim in diverse venues around the world including US, Canada, Mexico, Central America, Chile, and Germany. The program includes works by Beethoven, Ravel, and Villa-Lobos as well as original compositions by Barrera. A wine reception will follow the recital to which everyone is cordially invited. $25 Advance tickets are available at https://www.ticketsignup.io/Barrera.

Sunday, September 27, 7:30 p.m.
Festival Opera Vocal Salon

Walnut Creek's ***Festival Opera Association*** continues its 2026 season with the first of three events in this year's *Salon Series*, which will celebrate the launch of Festival Opera's new *Resident Artist Program* with a concert of arias and scenes featuring the exceptional talents of our inaugural class of resident artists, followed by a wine reception where you can meet the artists. Resident artist sopranos **Marielle Leiboff** and **Rachel Nelson**, mezzo-soprano **Phoebe Dinga**, tenor **Spencer Greene**, baritone **Liam Daley**, and pianist **Daniel Lockert** will showcase arias and scenes from operas composed by Verdi, Handel, Mozart, Strauss, Massenet, Bizet, Lehar, Leoncavallo, Tesori, and Bernstein. Doors will open at 7:00 p.m. Please buy advance tickets for this show or for the series at https://tinyurl.com/FestivalSalon1.

Saturday, October 3, 7:00 p.m.
Mads Tolling with Kenny Washington

Two-time Grammy Award-winning Danish violinist **Mads Tolling** returns to PCA with prolific pianist **John R. Burr** and Grammy-nominated vocalist **Kenny Washington** for the fourth time the three of them will perform together. The trio will perform their own music as well as that of composers Chick Corea, Ornette Coleman, and the group Toto, along with songs from the *American Songbook*, including the Temptations, Carol King, and jazz greats like Thelonious Monk and George Gershwin. Advance tickets are recommended, as this show is likely to sell out, and are available at https://www.ticketsignup.io/jazzviolin, and doors will open at 6:30 p.m.

Friday, October 9, 6:00 p.m.
Michael Stehr Art Lecture

A Friday night Extravaganza! Art historian **Michael Stehr** presents a spirited, illustrated 50-minute lecture exploring Michelangelo's work in his hometown of Florence, Italy. At the age of 29, he would put the finishing touches on his David, likely one of the most recognizable sculptures in Western Art. As he moved through his forties, this sculptor, painter, architect, and poet of the High Renaissance would continue to yield sculptural masterpieces and explore the art of architecture at San Lorenzo, the parish church of the Medici family. In 1534, he moved to Rome and only returned to Florence after his passing almost another thirty years later. Doors open at 5:30 p.m. Please bring $20 (cash only) per person to pay for entrance at the door.

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www.piedmontcenterforthearts.org

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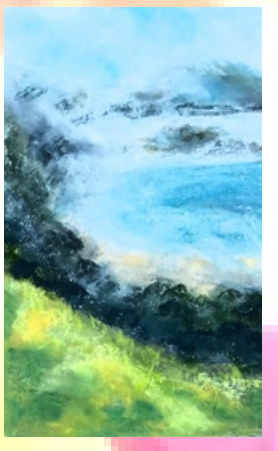
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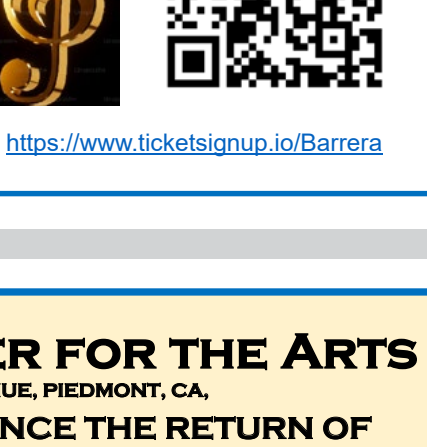
Impressões Seresteiras - **Heitor Villa-Lobos**

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For $25 advance tickets, please visit: https://www.ticketsignup.io/Barrera

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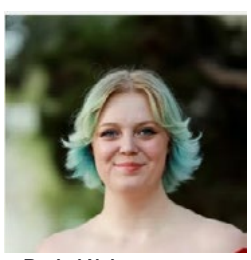
Resident Artist Showcase

Sunday, September 27, 2026

(Doors open 7:00) **7:30 PM** *note evening start time!*



Marielle Leiboff, soprano



Rachel Nelson, soprano



Phoebe Dinga, mezzo-soprano



Spencer Greene, tenor



Liam Daley, baritone



Daniel Lockert, pianist

Celebrate the launch of Festival Opera's new Resident Artist Program with a concert of arias and scenes featuring the exceptional talents of our inaugural class of resident artists.

(SUBSCRIBE TO SAVE $25 ON SERIES)

BUY TICKETS At: https://tinyurl.com/FestivalSalon1

SEE www.festivalopera.org for more program details when available

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KENNY WASHINGTON!

Described as one of "the Bay Area's best-kept musical secrets," Washington's astounding improvisational flights, inventive approach and emotional intensity are awe inspiring. If you have never heard this New Orleans native sing before, prepare to join a global audience that adores Washington's talent.

Mads and John will feature music from their 2023 album, *Ramblin'*, which includes songs ranging from Toto and the Beatles to John McLaughlin and Chick Corea, along with a few original compositions.



Kenny Washington, one of the world's premier jazz vocalists and a frequent performer at Wynton Marsalis' Jazz at Lincoln Center, will join them. Jazz writer Andrew Gilbert has dubbed Kenny "The Superman of the Bay Area Jazz Scene." Together, they will perform American Songbook tunes by Duke Ellington, Carole King, the Temptations, Thelonious Monk, and George Gershwin.

SATURDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2026

7:00 PM (DOORS OPEN AT 6:30)

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FEATURES

Walking on Wednesday

Wednesday Walkers tour old and new architecture in the Piedmont City Center

By Jim Kellogg

The Piedmont Recreation Department's Walking on Wednesdays group had an excellent turnout of 58 walkers and six K-9 best friends for their July 8 walk starting at the Exedra.

Dick Carter introduced Matthew Hawk, a new participant joining the walk that morning. Announcements done, Dick turned the reins over to Jim Kellogg, who would lead the walk.

Jim started by noting that the morning would focus on old and new architecture in the Piedmont City Center. We think of the "old" city center as built from about 1900 to 1920, but many "new" additions have been made, and when done well the two blend together to add to the beauty and value of our city.

The first stop was the beautiful courtyard of Piedmont Community Church, where Don Ashburn, PCC associate pastor, met the walkers and talked about the heritage of the church. PCC was formed in 1910 as the first non-denominational church west of the Mississippi. The original goal, which still applies today, was to be a church that reflected the diversity of a Piedmont that was growing and drawing people from all parts of America.

Jim then talked about Albert Farr's 1917 design, with the sanctuary and Guild Hall opening onto the courtyard, each with Spanish Mission style bell towers, the sanctuary with a copper roofed chancel dome, and the two connected by a mission style arched walkway. Additions that were not part of Farr's original design have added a great deal to what is seen today. The first example is the second level office and administration wing above the arched walkway, designed in 2005 by Piedmont architects Bill and Vicky Kendrick in Spanish Mission style, with detailing that integrates seamlessly with the original building. The walkers took a group photo there.

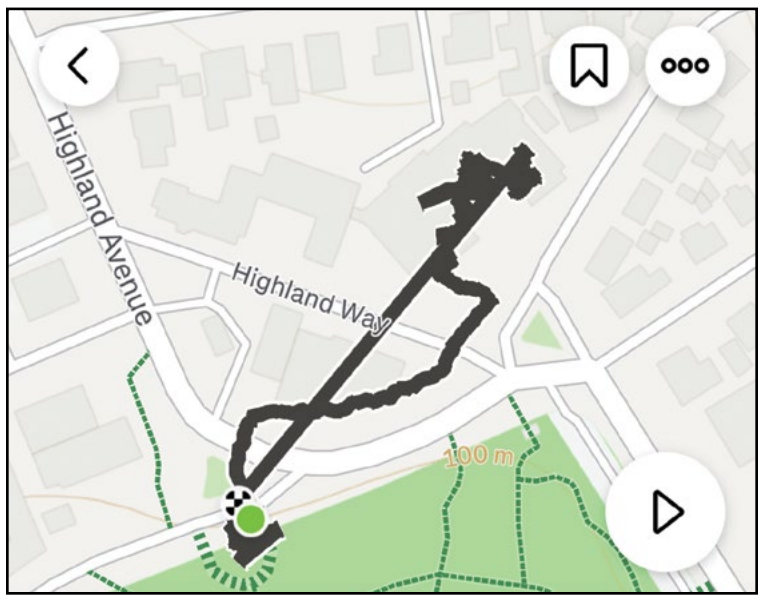
The group then proceeded into the sanctuary, which is Farr's original Spanish Mission style with open wood roof trusses, stucco walls and Spanish carved wood detailing. Here too, new elements add to what we see today. First is the stunning stained glass leaded window collection on the side walls, designed and built by James Hubbell in 1998 to replace the original windows that were showing their age. The large narthex Psalm 23 window is also new, redesigned in 2017 after the original stained glass began falling out of the lead frames and onto the floor. Something had to be done. The leaded glass work was done by The Hyland Studio in Santa Clara, one of the few remaining stained glass artisans in Northern California.

Next is the large projecting bay at the chancel choir loft, under the chancel dome, added in 2005 as part of the Kendricks' remodel, which also brought three new octagonal chancel windows designed by Hubbell. And last is the church's grand organ. The church decided in 1957 that a grand organ was needed, and it was built to order by Mathias P. Moller, with pipe ranks up to 32 feet high and installed in a wood sound box behind the chancel screen. Moller immigrated to America from Denmark in 1892, and his shop built organs for the West Point and Naval Academy chapels. This just goes to show that immigrants to America can add significant value to our culture.

In due course, however, all good things get old. By 2018 the console keys were sticking, the air bellows were wheezing and the pipes were leaking, and a complete restoration was required, done by Hupalo and Repasky Master Organ Builders in San Francisco. Walkers lined up to poke their heads into the wood sound box on the side of the chancel and see the inner workings of a grand organ.

The group was then off down Highland Avenue, pausing at 1900 Oakland Avenue, the Rackcliffe-Coffin House, built in 1899. Jim called it the most beautiful Queen Anne style home in Piedmont, but not all original: its

See Wednesday Walkers on page 29



Route map



Piedmont walkers take a group photo at Piedmont Community Church.



Don Ashburn, PCC associate pastor, talking to the Walkers



Jim Kellogg talking to Walkers inside Piedmont Community Church



FIRST MONDAYS READING GROUP

First Mondays Reading Group discusses *Horse* by Geraldine Brooks

By Dick Carter

On Monday, September 14, the First Mondays Reading Group met inside the Community Hall for their monthly book discussion. This was actually the second Monday of the month, as the Labor Day holiday had pushed their meeting back a week. The group received an excellent turnout of 24 participants to discuss their August book, *Horse*, by Geraldine Brooks.

Horse is a 2022 historical fiction novel by Australian author Geraldine Brooks. She interlinks three periods with the thoroughbred racehorse Lexington and the enslaved person who groomed him in the 1850s. This is a story of slavery and social justice through the lens of art related to the horse's celebrated life.

The novel takes place in three periods: 1850s pre-Civil War Kentucky, 1950s New York, and 2019 through a painting discovered by Theo, a Nigerian-born Georgetown University graduate student. Brooks blends real history with her fictional story of an enslaved groom named Jarret who nurtured an extraordinarily strong connection with Lexington. This legendary horse won seven of its eight races, was the fastest horse for twenty years, and produced hundreds of race-winning offspring.

The painting is rooted in real artwork produced by artists of the time, like itinerant painter Thomas J. Scott. Upon Lexington's death, the horse's skeletal remains were rearticulated, displayed for some time by the Smithsonian Museum, stored away for decades, and then rediscovered. Lexington's importance to racing and breeding was largely forgotten until the 1970s.

The novel brings together many different topics: slavery and freedom, the hidden brutality behind the sport of horse racing, the constant pull of greed, the development of the genre of equine art, New York City art galleries, interracial romance, and contemporary police brutality against people of color.

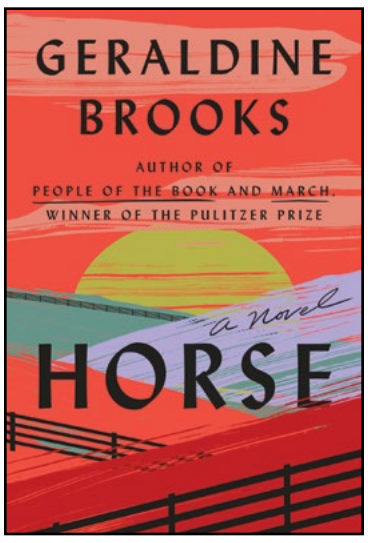
Horse was well received by critics and also the reading group. It was noted that Brooks was initially a reporter, and the deep research she did to present Lexington's history and also the novel's human characters, with some license taken in historical accuracy, was appreciated. Readers appreciated that the author resurrected a largely lost past.

The group valued how Brooks wove the different characters and time periods together to present her social justice message. Readers liked how she blended the actual histories of the book's characters with her fictionalized enhancements. Readers agreed that the histories of the horse and characters were better than the fictional elements. It was expressed that Brooks seemed to add a romantic component to satisfy her readers. It was noted that the love story might make the book more sellable as a movie where the characters Jarret and Lexington might be more fully developed. Jarret's powerful commitment to the horse was also noted. He preferred to remain enslaved rather than lose his connection to the horse.

Many readers would have preferred Brooks stay with Lexington and the horse's real history. In fact, one reader only read the chapters dealing with Lexington and Jarret and skipped those dealing with the story's romantic relationship. It was said that a good writer makes the reader care about a book's characters, and this might have been a criticism of the book.

One topic of discussion was Brooks' use of the common, contemporary writing technique of jumping back and forth between multiple time periods. While some readers had an issue with it, most readers generally thought Brooks did it well and filled in gaps that increased their understanding of her narrative.

Some readers didn't realize how racist and brutal horse racing was during this period, but they did recognize that some elements of it remain today. Brooks brought the racism of today front and center with a shocking murder that connected the fear and discrimination that Jarret and Theo shared over the generations. The murder brought Lexington's story home to our times.



***Horse* by Geraldine Brooks**

Readers generally liked *Horse*, but a reader of Brooks' other works felt it might not be her best book. However, the group agreed they learned a lot from the book and that *Horse* had provided for a good discussion. That also made it a good book for the First Mondays Reading Group.

The group had previously selected *Freezing Order* by Bill Browder for October, and *The Correspondent* by Virginia Evans for their November read. After Dick Carter presented three fiction candidates, the readers selected *All Creatures Great and Small* by James Herriot for their December book. With all their business done, they took a group photo in the circle outside the Community Hall.

The readers will meet at the Community Hall for their next discussion on October 5 at 1:30 p.m. New readers are welcome. There is no fee to participate, but registration is required at https://bit.ly/3R86PP4.

READ IT IN THE *POST*

Piedmont Branch Library News

Chair Yoga

Thursday, September 24 — 10:30 – 11:30 a.m.

Chair yoga is designed for those who have difficulty getting up and down from the floor due to arthritis, knee injury, back pain or any other reason.

Learn from a certified yoga instructor how a daily practice will improve your strength, flexibility, and balance. Meditation elements are included to help you develop greater body awareness and to help you set your intention before the class.

Taught by local instructor Bett Bollhoefer, who is certified in Radiant Body Yoga.

Walk & Listen: A Piedmont Ave Branch Audiobook Club

Saturday, September 26 — 9:30 – 10:30 a.m.

Take your story outdoors! Join us at the Piedmont Branch Library for a relaxed community walk through our beautiful neighborhood — sometimes all the way to the Morcom Rose Garden.

We can listen to our own audiobooks together, stroll among blooming roses or quiet tree-lined streets, and end back at the library for a short, low-pressure conversation. Bring headphones, your device, and your curiosity. All listeners welcome!

Note: New to Libby or Hoopla? No problem. Arrive 15 minutes early, and we'll help you get set up.

MOCHA At The Library!

Saturday, September 26 — 11:00 a.m. – 12:30 p.m.

Join us for monthly art workshops for children and families led by teachers from the Museum of Children's Art (MOCHA).

For ages 5-15 and caregivers.

MOCHA workshops focus on building creativity, social-emotional and academic skills through art.

Knitting & Crochet Circle with Susan Segal!

Monday, September 28 — 11:00 a.m. – 1:00 p.m.

Join us every second and fourth Monday of the month for a delightful early afternoon of yarn, needles, and good company at our Adult Knitting & Crochet Circle!

Settle into a warm and inviting space where creativity and conversation intertwine.

If you need assistance with anything or have questions, Susan is here to help. Join us and make the most of your knitting/crochet experience with us!

What to Bring:

- Your current knitting or crochet project
- Your preferred yarn and needles/hooks
- A smile and a willingness to connect with fellow crafters

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Songs, active rhymes and stories especially for ages 18 months to 3 years. Every Tuesday morning at 10:15 a.m.

Stay and play after Storytime with fun age-appropriate toys through 11:15 a.m. If conditions allow, Storytime will be held outside the library building.

We ask that patrons refrain from wearing scented products.

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Among those participating were Albert Chen, Alicia Rivera, Marj Blackwell, Peggy Shultz, Judy Love, Susie Backer, Rob White, Kristin Howard, Mike Henn, Nancy Henn, Adrienne Hamlin, Bella Almanzan, Orrel Lanter, Darby Gragg, Melba Yee, Sandy Threlfall, Marion Lim Yankowitz, Mary Carter, discussion leader Priscilla Wanerus, Claudia Cate, Phyllis Van Kranenburgh, and Dick Carter. The group was pleased to welcome Mary Holt and Russell Van Herik, who were there for the first time.

CoachArt Field Day brings children, families together in Piedmont

On July 25, Beach Play Field in Piedmont was filled with colorful team banners, soccer balls, laughter and plenty of cheering as children and families came together for a special CoachArt Field Day.

The event brought together patients from Benioff Children's Hospital Oakland and their siblings for a morning of adapted sports, games and community. Led by CoachArt volunteers and Piedmont teens, and supported by the Piedmont Recreation Department, the Field Day gave children an opportunity to play, connect and simply enjoy being kids.

CoachArt provides free adaptive lessons in arts, athletics and STEM for children affected by serious illness. Volunteer mentors create safe, encouraging experiences tailored to each child's needs. For families navigating serious illness, those experiences can help restore moments of childhood that might otherwise be lost.

George Saunders, a longtime CoachArt volunteer and Piedmont High School junior, proposed the idea for a Piedmont Field Day and, along with CoachArt National Program Director Erick Rodriguez, brought the event together from the ground up. George and fellow students from Piedmont High School and Piedmont Middle School, Jonah Cha Foster, Joaquin Fierro, Emmy Hong and Jane Saunders, volunteered their time at the July event, helping organize activities, work with the teams and make the morning welcoming for every participant.

The Piedmont Recreation Department was instrumental in making the Field Day possible. Liam Kelly, Recreation Supervisor, helped coordinate the event, provided props and materials for the activities, and issued a permit allowing CoachArt to use Beach Play Field.

Participants were given CoachArt T-shirts and divided into teams, each assigned its own color. Before the athletic activities began, children and volunteers worked together to create colorful banners representing their teams. Over snacks and conversation, the teams got to know one another, creating connections before heading out onto the field.

When it was time to play, teams rotated through a series of adapted activities, including soccer, Wiffle ball and relay races. Volunteer coaches and student volunteers helped participants take part at their own pace, creating an atmosphere where everyone could contribute and have fun. One CoachArt parent commented, "My family has been wearing their CoachArt T-shirts proudly and has been sharing about the program with family and friends. My daughter feels super supported by the experience."

For the Piedmont students who volunteered, the day offered a chance to give back to their community while helping create an enjoyable experience for participants and their families. Saunders commented, "I am so happy that this idea came to life. It was fun and meaningful to see the Piedmont and CoachArt communities come together for a great day!"

The morning wrapped up with more time for the children and volunteers to spend together, along with raffle prizes for participants. CoachArt's Executive Director, Molly Dirr, said, "The CoachArt families had a great time and enthusiastically shared that they would love to do it again!" Saunders hopes to make the Field Day an annual end-of-summer event in Piedmont and plans to roll out similar field day events in other CoachArt communities throughout the United States.



George Saunders, Jonah Cha Foster, Joaquin Fierro, Emmy Hong and Jane Saunders along with CoachArt volunteers and patients from Benioff Children's Hospital Oakland and their families gather for a field day at Beach Play Field.



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jepstein@piedmont.ca.gov or
Piedmont Recreation Department: 510.420.3070

Adventures in Scouting

Why Scouting Matters

By Brad Cardon

Many of my most cherished childhood memories came from Scouting. I went all the way through, earning my Arrow of Light and achieving the rank of Eagle Scout, like my dad before me. I grew up in San Diego with a core group of friends whom I met in first grade through Scouting. We camped, explored, learned new skills, and, most importantly, spent time together. Scouting gave us a chance to disconnect from school, sports, and everything else going on, and simply be kids. I'm still friends with many members of this Scouting group today—we have a group chat where we connect nearly daily, and we make a point of getting together at least once a year. Irreplaceable.

I wanted that same experience for my two boys, now in fifth and second grade. I'm thrilled that they love Cub Scouts. It gives them a chance to get outside, put their feet in the dirt, play with sticks, sleep in a tent, and discover that having fun doesn't require a screen. My second grader's favorite experience is camping at Rock City on Mount Diablo. I barely saw him as he was having so much fun with his friends. My fifth grader also loves camping, but his favorite tradition is the Pinewood Derby. We've worked together on his car every year in our garage—it's great father-son time.

We're a big sports family. Between soccer play dates, basketball practices, flag football games, and regular season and travel ball schedules, our calendar gets busy. But I believe kids can—and should—do both. Scouting doesn't have to compete with sports—it complements it. Scouting isn't competitive, which is a nice change for kids. Cub Scouts gives kids a place to try something new without worrying about whether they'll be good at it or even do it correctly. The Cub Scout motto is "Do Your Best," which says a lot about what Scouting is all about.

As a parent and volunteer, I love what Scouting teaches: leadership, citizenship, service, helping others, and appreciation for nature. Yet I also love seeing kids smile and helping them create experiences that they'll carry with them.

I'm especially grateful for the parents who lead our pack. They are creative, dedicated, and committed to making every meeting and event fun. Scouting has a way of bringing out the best in people.

For our family, Cub Scouts is one of the few places where the goal is simply to be together, get outside, and have a good time. You don't have to do everything. You just have to show up, bring a good attitude, and do your best. And sometimes, that's more than enough.



The Cub Scout Den at the Piedmont Fire Department



Landry (right) with friends in Muir Woods



Cub Scouts hike in Reinhardt Redwood Regional Park



Brad & Marissa Cardon with their boys Landry and Beau hiking in Austria



Landry Cardon at his first Webeloree, Bort Meadow



Landry Cardon at the Piedmont Council Pinewood Derby



Beau Cardon and a friend at the Piedmont Council Pinewood Derby



Landry with his dad, Brad, at the Kirby Cove Cub Scout overnighter



Landry & Beau Cardon at Crater Lake, Oregon

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ADVERTISE IN THE *POST*

New Families Night this Friday

By Jay Russell

Families who are new to Piedmont schools or have moved into the neighborhood in recent years are invited for an evening of socializing at the Piedmont Community Hall Courtyard Patio this Friday, September 25. The fun and informal New Families Night starts at 5:30 p.m., just before Movie Night in Piedmont Park, providing a full evening of entertainment.

Elected leaders from City Council and the School Board will be on hand to meet residents, as will City and Piedmont Unified School District staff. New residents are invited to come for the free light refreshments, "meet your neighbors" bingo, and raffle prizes.

"This is one of my personal favorite events of the year. It's a very informal, mix-and-mingle type event but spirits are always high and new residents have always been very appreciative of the opportunity to meet others in the same boat," said City Communication Manager Echa Schneider.



New Piedmont residents are encouraged to come meet their neighbors September 25 on the patio of Community Hall.



At last year's New Families event, City Administrator Rosanna Bayon Moore served lemonade.

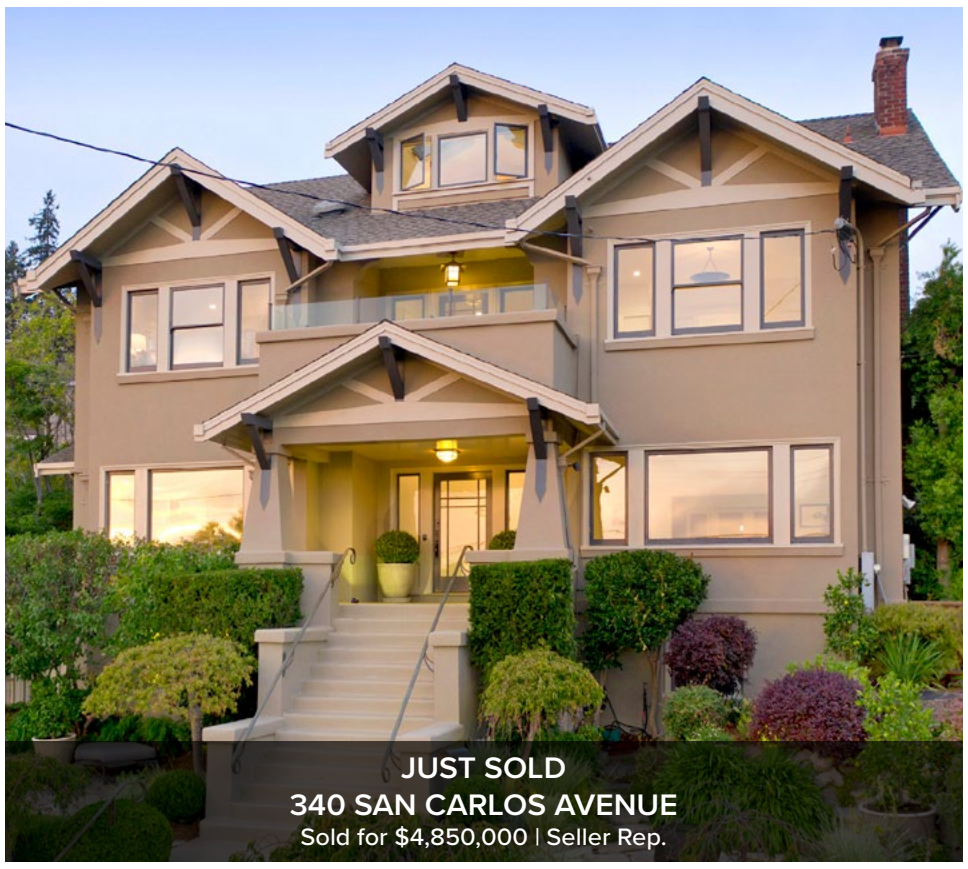
Check out a video from last year's event to get excited about what the event will offer at https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ke3mW1izyYQ

Following the New Families Night, the City will screen its second Movie in the Park. A large screen on the Piedmont Park lawn, will have the 2025 Disney and Pixar film, Elio, starting at 7:15 p.m.

READ IT IN THE *POST*

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3 BD | 1.5 BA | 1,700 SQFT
LISTED FOR $1,049,000



67 Lincoln Ave., Piedmont
5 BD | 4 BA | 3,841 SQFT
SOLD FOR $4,374,750



66 Manor Dr., Piedmont
4 BD | 3 BA | 2,983 SQFT
SOLD FOR $4,200,000



25 Manor Dr., Piedmont
5 BD | 2.5 BA | 2,473 SQFT
SOLD FOR $3,500,000



136 Arbor Dr., Piedmont
4 BD | 3 BA | 2,352 SQFT
SOLD FOR $2,670,000



423 Pacific Ave., Piedmont
4 BD | 3 BA | 2,319 SQFT
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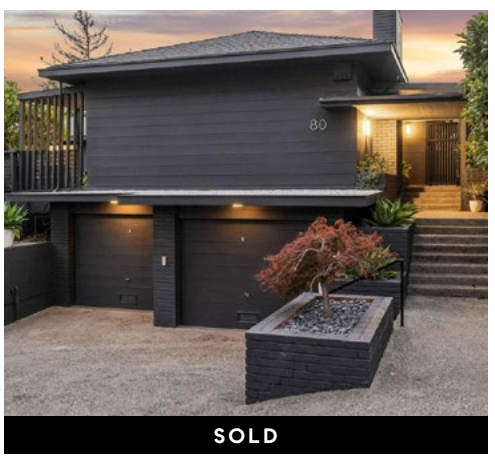
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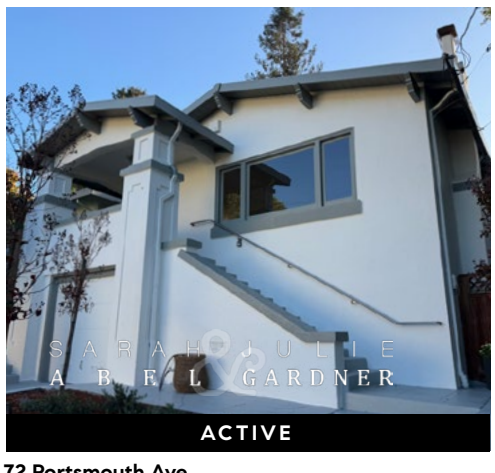
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Piedmont hosts third Food Truck Friday



Families lay out blankets on the park's lawn after receiving their food from the trucks.

By Jake Lannon

Hundreds of Piedmonters flocked to Piedmont Park on Friday, September 18, to enjoy the third Food Truck Friday. From 5 to 8 p.m., residents lined up to try savory foods and listen to music with their friends and family. The event preceded Piedmont High School's Homecoming, allowing families to grab dinner before heading to the football game.

Five food trucks were available on Highland Avenue for attendees to choose from. They included Golden Gate Gyro, Sausage King, El Gran Taco Loco, Crazy Empanadas Truck, and Pineapple Whips. These trucks provided a wide selection of sweet and savory foods, like pineapple drinks, hot dogs, empanadas, burritos, and gyros. From this reporter's view, the most popular trucks were El Gran Taco Loco and Golden Gate Gyro, with lines extending deep onto the lawn.

Piedmonters laid out their blankets for a picnic on the park's grass after getting their food. Kids ran around the lawn and played at the tot lot nearby. The event gave many the chance to step back and have a nice evening catching up with friends and family.



A family orders from the Gyro food truck.



A man surveys the menu from the Sausage King food truck.



The reporter's meal of a regular burrito and horchata drink from El Gran Taco Loco.

This reporter sampled the regular burrito and horchata from El Gran Taco Loco. The truck offers three meats for your burritos or tacos: chicken, beef, and pork. I decided to choose the chicken. The burrito came with beans, chicken, rice, and pico de gallo, and two spicy salsas on the side. The burrito was well cooked, and the chicken had that perfect grilled taste. The salsas were the perfect amount of spice to balance out the sweet horchata drink. Overall, I give the meal four out of five stars.

The Rec Department will host a movie in the park on September 25, *Elio*, an animated kids' movie that follows a young boy's journey through space with different aliens. The next Food Truck Friday will be on October 16.



Families wait in long lines to order their food.

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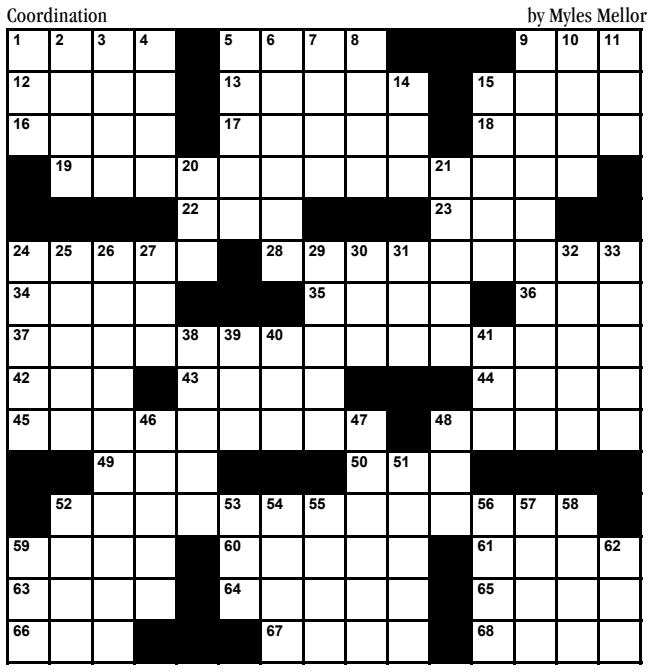
Sudoku Puzzle

Sudoku by Myles Mellor

	6	2		3				
3				9	8	5		
			5					6
	1		2	6		7		
							4	
						1		
	3		7	8				
	8	6	1			3		9
		5				2		

Crossword Puzzle

Coordination by Myles Mellor



ACROSS

1. Cut some opinions, perhaps
5. Mouth off to
9. Special effects, abbr.
12. Mob boss
13. Steamed up
15. Rude
16. Roughly
17. Bother persistently
18. Any day now
19. Joining forces
22. Content of some barrels
23. Dwarf in "The Hobbit"
24. Makes a bundle
28. Religious pieces
34. Milky white gem
35. S-shaped curve
36. Small GM car
37. Combining at the office
42. Unit of energy
43. Former Israeli P.M.
44. ___ monde (high society)
45. Became more sharply inclined
48. Ostentatious displays
49. Return envelope, abbr.
50. Rock music style
52. Getting it done as a group
59. Sports org. since 1906
60. US novelist, Joyce
61. Equips with weapons
63. Waist band
64. Image on many a birth announcement
65. Sequential scale notes
66. Suffix for orange or lemon
67. CPR pros
68. Houston and Browne

DOWN

1. Environmentalist's prefix
2. Ste. Jeanne ___
3. "Facto" intro
4. Hammer or sickle
5. Moses's mountain
6. Like farmland
7. Kind of palm
8. Betelgeuse, for one
9. American dancer, Merce
10. Mixture of rum and water
11. BBC rival
14. Pilot's announcement, for short
15. Egyptian city
20. West coast city part
21. Plain ___
24. Pitney's partner
25. Ship's left side
26. Of great scope
27. BPOE part
29. "À ___ santé!"
30. It may need a boost
31. Item in a photog's file
32. Go faster!
33. Catalogues
38. Louvre pyramid architect
39. Society page word
40. Beefeater, for one
41. Simplified "though"
46. Bother terribly
47. Leave
48. Coffee container
51. Halloween coverups
52. Breezed through
53. Votes against
54. Ticket sales
55. Little matter
56. Cereal spikes
57. "Diamonds ___ Girl's Best Friend"
58. "Tasty!"
59. Basketball association
62. Genetically close

See Crossword and Sudoku Puzzle Solutions on page 28.

Candidates Q&A

Continued from page 1

Short-term priorities include regularly scheduled maintenance and replacement projects, as well as fixing unplanned hazards that — if left unaddressed — could lead to more costly repairs or liability exposure. These include items like street paving, sidewalk repair, and hazardous tree removal, and should be planned for in the annual budget.

Medium-term priorities include larger capital repairs, ADA upgrades, new equipment, technology, and upgrades that are known but may be beyond the reach of the current-year budget. Sequencing of these projects can change with the availability of municipal funding, limited state and regional grants, and community fundraising efforts.

Long-term infrastructure needs (10+ years) include replacing or rebuilding older city buildings, particularly our fire and police stations. These buildings are in use 24 hours a day, are expensive to maintain, and are suboptimal for their current needs. While rebuilding these facilities would require significant financial and logistical planning, it may also present an opportunity to consider additional civic assets such as a library or senior center.

Nancy Beninati
(NancyforPiedmont.com)

I believe Piedmont's top infrastructure needs are reflected in the City's most recent budget: maintaining and improving our streets and sidewalks, upgrading our stormwater and sewer systems, and maintaining and modernizing our public facilities, including parks and recreational facilities. I support the City's focus on these areas, while also considering public safety, emergency preparedness, and sustainability throughout these projects.

I care about the Piedmont community, and with aging infrastructure and ongoing maintenance needs, we have a responsibility to take care of what we have while

planning thoughtfully for the future. Places like our Community Hall, pool, parks, and other

City facilities are part of what makes Piedmont special. They are where friends and families gather, make memories, and build community, and they should remain vibrant and welcoming.

If elected, I would listen to residents, review the City's capital improvement plans and financial projections, and work with City staff and fellow councilmembers to determine which projects should receive attention first. I would consider condition, public safety, urgency, community impact, available funding, and long-term financial consequences. I want to help take care of the Piedmont we have today while making thoughtful choices about the Piedmont we leave for the next generation.

Sunny Bostrom-Flemming

In my opinion, the most important infrastructure issues are the ones directly related to safety. At least twice a week, I ride my bike down Oakland Ave on the way to Trader Joe's, having to dodge cracks in the pavement and potholes big enough to drown a baby chihuahua.

Like the city of Alameda, I also recommend a citywide speed limit of 25 miles per hour, and less where posted. The issue of the state mandate requiring 587 new housing units in Piedmont is going to require all of our best effort to provide infrastructure for police, fire, and schools. If the same housing mandate rule applied in Oakland, where they have a current population of 440,000, they will have 80,000 people added that will need housing, education, police, fire, and infrastructure.

Any city with this type of situation would have tremendous infrastructure challenges, but I am confident that Piedmont, with its population of men, women, and children of good will and hard work, can meet this challenge.

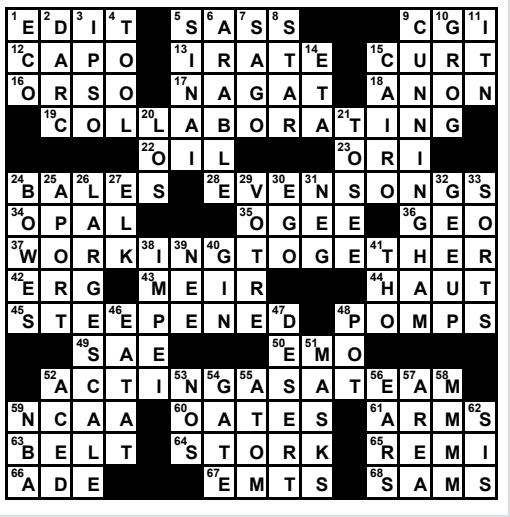
Candidate Score Card

Candidates	Top 3 issues facing Piedmont	Measure GG	Top 3 infrastructure needs
Tom Ramsey (*Incumbent)*	Community safety, fiscal responsibility, and maintaining the beauty of our town	Supports Measure GG	Sewers and storm drains, pavement management, and aging civic buildings
Nancy Beninati	Public Safety, Good Governance, Preserving Community and Sustainability (resident-first approach to City Hall)	Supports Measure GG	Maintaining and improving streets and sidewalks, upgrading stormwater and sewer systems, and maintaining and modernizing public facilities
Bill Reichle	Moraga Canyon housing, sustainability, and updating century-old city facilities	Supports Measure GG	Street paving, ADA upgrades, and replacing or rebuilding older city buildings
Adam Hundt	Energy inefficiency and Affordable electrification, building new homes, and raising city revenue	Supports Measure GG	Mitigating risk from hazards that could affect residents' housing, renovating and modernizing city buildings, and maintaining roads and enhancing crosswalks and bike pathways
Nancy Bostrom	*No response received*	Supports Measure GG	*No response received*

SUDOKU SOLUTION

5	6	2	4	3	1	9	8	7
3	4	7	6	9	8	5	2	1
1	9	8	5	7	2	4	3	6
8	1	4	2	6	3	7	9	5
6	5	3	9	1	7	8	4	2
7	2	9	8	5	4	1	6	3
2	3	1	7	8	9	6	5	4
4	8	6	1	2	5	3	7	9
9	7	5	3	4	6	2	1	8

CROSSWORD SOLUTION



Letters to the Editor

Continued from page 2

Council member.

I strongly encourage my fellow residents to support Nancy Beninati for City Council. As Nancy has already done for many years, she will bring thoughtful and principled leadership to the Council.

–Tanya Koshy
Piedmont

In support of Beninati, Reichle, Ramsey

Editor,

I write to enthusiastically express my support for Nancy Beninati, Tom Ramsey, and Bill Reichle for Piedmont City Council. All three of these candidates are proven leaders in our community. Nancy and I worked closely together as volunteers with the League of Women Voters of Piedmont where she served as President. Her leadership, collaborative spirit, and support of our community are unwavering, not just with the League, but also through serving on multiple Piedmont Commissions. Her professional background as a supervising attorney at the California DOJ and lecturer at UC Berkeley make her exceedingly qualified and ready to work on the issues most important to Piedmont residents.

Tom and I have served on the City Council together since December of 2024. He always puts the residents of Piedmont first and has a positive, solution-oriented outlook. He is the epitome of a good public servant and good steward for our city's funds.

Bill is also a longstanding volunteer in Piedmont, supporting our schools that are a cornerstone in our community. His experience as Assistant Vice Chancellor at UC Berkeley makes him highly qualified to make the decisions required of Councilmembers in a way that best serves Piedmont.

I urge my fellow Piedmont voters to cast their votes for Nancy, Tom, and Bill for Piedmont City Council.

– Lorrel Plimier

Support Measure GG

Editor,

The strength of our public schools is intertwined with the strength of our City. Police, fire, public works, schoolmates, and PMS sports are all priorities for our residents and part of the services provided by the City of Piedmont. Our beautiful parks and all playfields (except the Witter Sports Complex) are owned and operated by the City of Piedmont. Implementing public safety improvements in and around school sites depends in part on having a sustainable funding stream.

Piedmont voters passed Measure H to support our schools, and now it's time for voters to pass Measure GG to support our City. Measure GG is not a parcel tax. It is a one-time tax incurred when real property is transferred. All proceeds from Measure GG stay here in Piedmont to fund the services and facilities upon which the School District, and all of us, rely. Please join me in supporting Measure GG. To learn more and show your support, please visit YesonMeasureGG.com

–Ruchi Medhekar

Why I am voting for Nancy Beninati

Editor,

I am pleased to endorse Nancy Beninati for Piedmont City Council.

Nancy brings the kind of experience and perspective that would strengthen our City Council. Her public service at the California Department of Justice, combined with her work as a UC Berkeley lecturer in law and public policy, Nancy understands government, policy, and the importance of thoughtful decision-making.

Just as importantly, Nancy has been actively involved in the Piedmont community for decades. She has served on the Civil Service Commission, as President of the League of Women Voters of Piedmont, and currently as a Recreation Commissioner. She has also volunteered in our schools and youth sports as her high school boys have grown up in Piedmont.

Nancy understands what makes Piedmont such a wonderful place to raise a family, and she cares about preserving that sense of community.

I look forward to working with Nancy on the City Council. She will bring a thoughtful, collaborative approach, listen to different perspectives, and work with her colleagues to find common ground and get things done for Piedmont.

I strongly encourage Piedmont voters to join me in electing Nancy Beninati to the City Council.

– Conna McCarthy
Vice-Mayor, City of Piedmont

PUBLIC NOTICE

NOTICE OF PUBLIC HEARING

The Piedmont Unified School District Board of Education will conduct a public hearing and adopt a Resolution in compliance with Education Code 60119(c) mandating that the governing board of school districts must hold a public hearing in order to receive funding for textbooks and instructional materials that are consistent with the Curriculum Framework adopted by the State Board of Education. The public hearing will be conducted at the Regular Board meeting on Wednesday, September 23, 2026 which begins at 7:00 p.m. in person at 120 Vista Avenue, Piedmont, and via Zoom webinar.

PUSD
Office of the Superintendent
760 Magnolia Avenue
Piedmont CA

September 12, 2026

Girls' Volleyball

Continued from page 12

execute. For me, personally, I'm trying to close out the block. For the team, we're working on our communication to avoid errors," said freshman Charlotte Bailey.

Match Recap

Piedmont kept each set within seven points, falling by scores of 25-19, 25-18, 17-25, 25-19.

In the first set, both teams traded points with PHS staying within striking distance down 13-11. But from there, Berkeley scored seven of nine points to take a 20-13 lead. The Highlanders crept closer to 20-18 with an ace by Olivia Stevens, a block by Fiona Olsen, and kills by Olsen and Lucia Dorsey. But from there, Berkeley finished strong by scoring five of the final six points to win 25-19.

It was similar in the second set with Piedmont holding an early 7-5 lead, but Berkeley came back to lead 8-7 and never relinquished. From there, BHS extended its lead to 16-9. Piedmont closed the gap to 17-15, but Berkeley finished by scoring eight of the final 11 points.

Piedmont's third-set win, Berkeley got out to a 5-3 lead before PHS went up 6-5 that included an ace by freshman Sarina Hill. Both teams exchanged points until PHS clung onto a narrow 17-16 advantage. From there, Piedmont scored eight of the final nine points with two kills by Sofia Meyer, one by Maika Ting, and a finishing ace by Stevens to clinch the set.

In the fourth set, Berkeley got out to a 10-6 lead, but Piedmont went up 12-10 with six straight points that featured two aces by Vora and a block by Dorsey. However, Berkeley went up 16-14 with a run of four straight points and never relinquished. PHS stayed closed down 21-18, but the Jackets scored four of the final five points to win.

Final stats: Olsen recorded two kills, two blocks and one dig. Ting recorded 13 kills, one block and four digs. Bailey recorded two kills, two blocks, one dig and one assist. Allyson Huynh recorded 17 digs and seven assists. Vora recorded two aces, one block, 19 digs and 16 assists. Izara Dando recorded two kills and one dig. Meyer recorded five kills, one block and one dig. Nora Trombi recorded three kills and one dig. Mia Bechtel recorded five digs and four assists. Stevens recorded two aces and nine digs. Dorsey recorded three kills, five blocks and two digs. Hill recorded three aces and two digs.

Tuesday vs. Encinal

Piedmont hosted Encinal on Tuesday, September 22. See next week's *Post* for match details.

NEXT UP

Piedmont (11-7 overall, 0-1 league) visits Bishop O'Dowd tonight, September 23, at 6:30 p.m.



Sofia Meyer makes one of her five kills against Berkeley.

JV Football

Continued from page 15

200 yards of total offense.

Hildreth contributed at both running back and quarterback. He connected with Burden for a goal-line touchdown before adding the two-point conversion on the ground.

"What may be the best RB performance I've seen since coaching," coach Pouyan Assadi said about Hildreth. "He ran low, cut when he needed, and hit the gas pedal when it made sense."

Piedmont put together three drives of roughly 50 yards or more, with two ending in touchdowns. The final score came late in the fourth quarter when Hildreth broke around the left side for a 35-yard touchdown on an outside pitch. A strong block from the offensive line and Lev Kuluva helped spring him into the open field, where he accelerated into the end zone, giving Piedmont the final 22-7 margin.

The defense finished the afternoon with a team sack by Demetri Adams and Ozem Fitzgerald. Aragon never found the end zone, and Piedmont closed out the game with another strong defensive performance.

With the win, Piedmont's defense has now allowed just three touchdowns over its last 10 quarters, and began a two-game winning streak they will look to continue this week against Moreau Catholic.



Ernie Hildreth (#6) punches in a two-point conversion to increase the Highlander lead.

Wednesday Walkers

Continued from page 20

second story addition was built in 2014 to a design by Piedmont architect Grier Graff, and the group was surprised to learn it was not part of the original house.

Other stops included 19 Hardwick Avenue, built in 1911, an American Foursquare with two high pitched gable roofs on each side of the front door; 505 Blair Avenue, built in 1940, a perfect example of Monterey style; 110 Monte Avenue, the Hunt House, built in 1907; and, on Park Way, the best Berkeley Arts and Crafts home in Piedmont at 506, built in 1905, facing the 1915 Prairie School house at 503.

The next stop was Waldo Avenue, which Jim described as the end of an era for the Piedmont City Center. In its early days Piedmont was thought of as "Queen of the Hills," with somewhat densely packed elite homes surrounded by pastoral farmland and panoramic vistas. The Waldo property, from Park Way to Blair and from Vernal Avenue (Highland Avenue today) to the backyards of the houses on Bonita Avenue, was part of farmland owned by Walter Blair, and the only parcel of pastureland west of Vernal. Blair's daughter Florence Blair inherited the property and continued to use it as pastureland until she died in 1925. That was the end of the old pastoral landscape attached to Piedmont's city center. The parcel was developed as a new neighborhood, Waldo Avenue, and all of the homes were built within a two year period by 1928. The plan made use of consistent front yard setbacks and two story massing that melded varying colors and styles into a very popular neighborhood, one that integrates well into today's Piedmont City Center.

The group continued south on Bonita Avenue past several other notable old homes, then past Havens School, built in 2010 and designed by Piedmont architect Mark Becker in traditional Spanish Mission Revival style.

The walk concluded at the observation deck at the north end of the Piedmont Community Swimming Pool, which is available for use by everyone. The group used it as a chance for a brief rest and to admire the spectacular view, greatly appreciated by all.

Walking on Wednesdays meets every week at 10:30 a.m. at the Exedra (Highland and Magnolia Avenues). The program is free and open to all, and new walkers—along with their K-9 best friends—are always welcome. Registration is required. For more information or to sign up, visit https://tinyurl.com/3ethkehu or call (510) 420-3070.



A Monterey style home on Blair Avenue: Sherry Jacobs, Mike Gallant, Sanghi Wagner, Alan Jolly, Caskey Weston, Sean Brient, Paul Glasser, Karen Glasser, Liz Dalrymple, Matt Gerhardt, Chuck Oraftik, Kristin Howard, June Yee, Mary Carter, Debbie Powell, Audrey Sung, Jim Kellogg, Claudine Bach, Rev. Don Ashburn, Charlene Louie, Marcia Arthurs, Mary Ann Barnes, Dave DeRoche, Judy Sokoloff, Joyce Ahern, Jim Kuo, Brian Hamlin, Kathleen Parkerton, Brenda Ferrero, Mike Henn with K-9 best friend Roger, Nancy DeRoche with K-9 best friend Pepper, Phil Witte, Lois Price, Joan Jung with K-9 best friend JT, Joyce Hicks with K-9 best friend Mocha, Rick Eigenbrode, Judy Love, Melba Yee, Max Becker, Peggy Shultz, Noemi Alvarado, Ken Moy, Adrienne Hamlin, Marion Lim Yankowitz, Allissa Quan, Bill Ahern, Karin Fetherston, Stacey Morgan, Mark Davis, Dan Scdonis, Edith Lee, Bern Schild, Jasmine Cai, Jack Fischrup with K-9 best friend Kojak, Deborah Curtin with K-9 best friend Brie, Vicki Trimbach, and Dick Carter.

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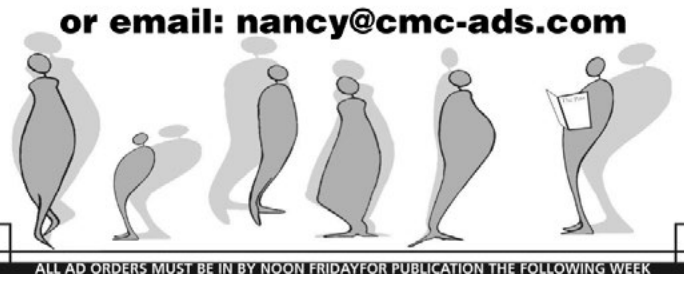
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Flag Football

Continued from page 14

Then on second down for San Lorenzo, Cory Minor returned an interception nearly 40-yards for a touchdown to end the first half, leading to a successful one-point conversion pass to Prata Baack – now 34-0.

Both teams traded possession in the third quarter until PHS scored to open the fourth. The Highlanders scored on a four-play, 50-yard drive that featured a 27-yard reception by Zoya Schulze and a six-yard touchdown run by Elmquist. A run by Kate Tong for the conversion made it 40-0 with 10:40 left in the game.

Piedmont's final touchdown came with 8:20 left in the game by way of a 10-yard run by Tong, making it 46-0 after an unsuccessful conversion.

NEXT UP

Piedmont (5-5 overall, 3-1 league) hosts Mt. Eden tomorrow, September 24, at 7:30 p.m.

Give us 30 minutes.

We'll help you turn "we should have a plan" into a plan.

- At-home wildfire evacuation exercise
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- Worksheet to capture your plan

piedmont.ca.gov/WildfirePlan

Where in the World Are We?



A Tale of Two Piedmonts. The Joerger (Alex, Evie, Hannah and Martha) and Fa (Eleck, Grace, Lindsay and Jack) families visited Piemonte, Italy, and took a break from the sun to survey the town of Barolo while catching up on the *Piedmont Post*.

Send your photos of the Post in the far corners of the world, or of other communities named Piedmont, to: WITWAW, 3756 Grand Ave., #203, Oakland, CA 94610.

Boys' Water Polo

Continued from page 12

Final stats: Stein led with five goals, one assist, and one steal. Patty recorded four goals and a steal. Van Den Bos had one goal and two steals. Jerez had five saves and two steals.

12-11 loss to San Marin

San Marin got out to a 5-1 lead through the first quarter, while Piedmont inched back in the second to make to 8-5 by halftime. The Mustangs put up three more goals to PHS' two in the third, while the Highlanders fell narrowly short of a comeback in the fourth quarter with four goals to San Marin's one.

Final stats: Stein logged a team-high nine goals, to go along with one assist and two steals. Smith had two goals and two steals. Jack Dahling scored once. Leo Maltz and Banin had one steal. Van Den Bos had an assist. Jerez had 13 saves, two steals, and two assists.

NEXT UP

Piedmont (5-6 overall, 0-1 league) hosts Encinal on Thursday, September 24 at 6:00 p.m. in a Western Alameda County Conference clash.

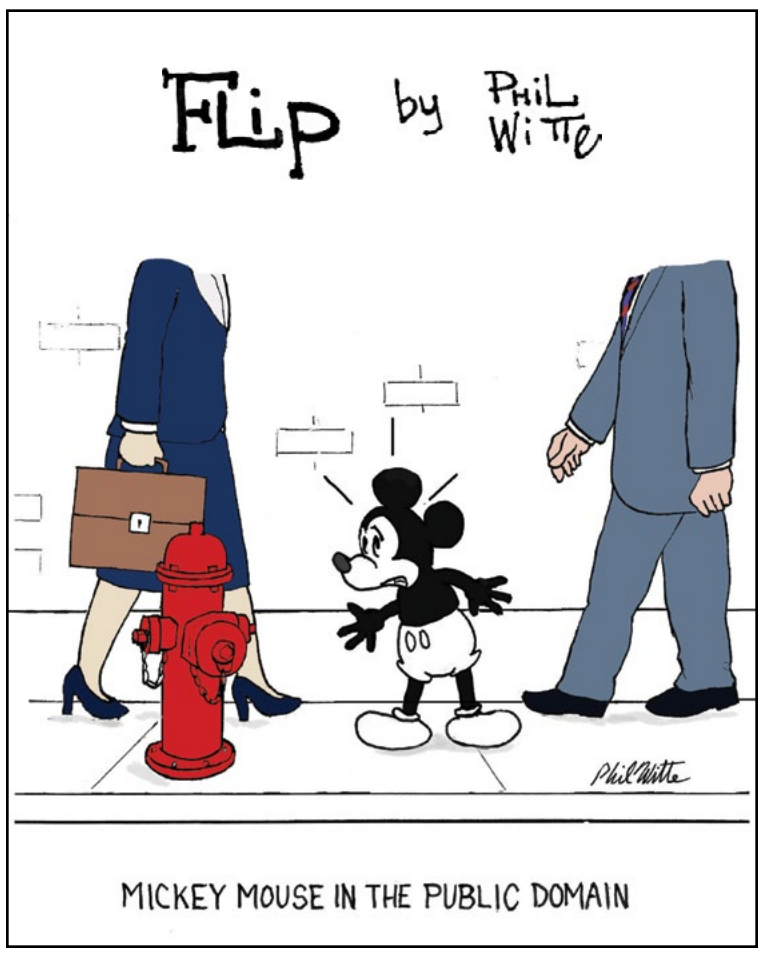


Henry Stein led Piedmont 24 total goals.



Goalie Dylan Jerez had 35 saves in four matches at the Vintage Valley Tournament.

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The race begins. The eventual winner, Rory Heywood, glides through the water with his paddle.



Competition winner Heywood holds his paddle proudly above his head.



Competition staff handing out the trophy to Heywood and his family.

2026 Calendar of Events

September 23 - September 30

Wednesday, September 23
7:00 p.m. ..... Board of Education Meeting ..... City Hall

Thursday, September 24
5:30 p.m. ..... Public Safety Committee ..... City Hall

Friday, September 25
5:30 p.m. ..... New Families Night ..... Piedmont Community Hall
7:15 p.m. ..... Movie in the park ..... Piedmont Park

Saturday, September 26
9:00 a.m. ..... Cars, Cops, and Coffee ..... 800 Magnolia Ave

Sunday, September 27
11:00 a.m. ..... 28th Harvest Festival ..... Piedmont Park
11:00 a.m. ..... Jazz Festival ..... Piedmont Park

Meetings may be viewed on KCOM (Channel 27) and on the City's website: piedmont.ca.gov.

Boat Race

Continued from page 1

boat with materials provided by staffers. Parents and kids worked together on a wide variety of designs.

The *Post* was at the age 7 & under group race, which featured three competitors. The biggest distinction between the boats was their choice of paddles. Parents lined up their kids at the far side of the pool and helped them into the water as they waited for the whistle to start the race.

Once the race began, the captain of the vessel with the longer paddle zoomed through the water, reaching the finish line with ease. The other two captains struggled to find their balance at times, but with the crowd's encouragement, they finished strong. A small boat trophy was handed to the winning boat. A video of part of the race will be on the Piedmont Post's Instagram on Wednesday, September 23.

Award Winners

Piedmont Cup *(Overall Fastest Time)*
Teddy Killion (Team Return to Ikea)

Fastest Time by category
7 & under: Rory Heywood (Team Fast Fish)
8–10-year-olds: Teddy Killion (Team Return to Ikea)
11–12-year-olds: Ellie Przybyla (Team Chomp)

Best Designs
Ellie Przybyla (Team Chomp)
Nico Riddle (Team The Real Return to Ikea)

Titanic Award *(for most spectacular sinking boat)*
Eloise Gross, Willa Gershwin, Chloe Wang (Team Grover)

Lifeguard's Choice *(for sportsmanship and spirit)*
Rory Heywood (Team Fast Fish)



2nd place winners with their boat.



Two kids with their boat after finishing the race.



The next age group begins working on their design for a boat.